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1 The ordered sound-change sequence

1.1 Scope and orientation

The sequence begins with early West Germanic consonant and vowel changes and ends with Old English r-metathesis.

Rhotacism, brightening, breaking, umlaut, and apocope alternate with narrowly conditioned changes whose relative order rests on particular witness words.

The evidence ranges from broadly attested sound laws to lexical constraints that establish only one chronological boundary.

1.2 Numbering note

SC numbers remain the established legacy identifiers. The Version 1 book presents the changes in historical chapter order, which differs from the computational cascade order for several rules.

SC038, SC062, and SC084 mark technical or prosodic stages rather than sound changes; SC077 is unused.

2 Chapter 1. From Proto-Germanic to Proto-Northwest Germanic

2.1 Historical interval

This chapter covers developments that took place within the Proto-Germanic period, from the inherited consonant system to the first changes that separate the Northwest Germanic line from the rest of the Germanic family.

The reconstruction labelled Proto-Germanic here is the common ancestor of Gothic, North Germanic, and West Germanic, reconstructed through the classical comparative method from attested descendant languages. The label Proto-Northwest Germanic designates the hypothetical node linking the ancestors of North Germanic (Old Norse and its relatives) and West Germanic (Old English, Old High German, Old Saxon, and Old Frisian among others), to the exclusion of Gothic and the other East Germanic varieties.

2.2 What this chapter contains

Chapter 1 contains one reader-facing sound-change section: the Proto-Germanic loss of a nasal before **x* (SC103 PGmcNasalLossBeforeX), with compensatory lengthening and nasalization of the preceding vowel. Its results are shared by every daughter language, Gothic included, so the change belongs to Proto-Germanic itself and precedes every Northwest Germanic and West Germanic development treated in the chapters that follow (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1; Ringe 2017, 149–50, §3.2.7).

Another historically Proto-Germanic rule, the positional allophony of Proto-Germanic **b* (SC049 PGmcBAllophony), executes late in the computational cascade because the alternation interacts with environments shaped by intermediate rule applications; its section therefore appears in Chapter 4, where the divergence between cascade placement and historical stage is noted explicitly.

One other historically Proto-Germanic change, Gm-simplification (SC002 PGmcGmSimplification), is documented in the book-entry plan and its literature dossier confirms the source base is narrow (two lexical families: **draugma*- ‘dream’ and **taugma*- ‘team’; (Kroonen 2013, 101, 511)). A reader-facing section for SC002 awaits a stronger explanatory source base and is not yet assembled in the reader-facing sequence.

2.3 Scope and genealogical context

Changes in this chapter are pan-Germanic in scope: they apply to ancestral forms that feed both the North Germanic and West Germanic descendants, or they represent internal Proto-Germanic processes visible across the Germanic family.

The boundary between Proto-Germanic and Proto-Northwest Germanic is not sharp in the textbook literature. Ringe and Taylor treat many of the traditionally “Proto-Germanic” changes as part of a shared innovation package that is diagnostically older than North–West Germanic divergence but not necessarily earlier than the separation of the East Germanic line (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 1–30). For book purposes, the distinction matters primarily because it separates the features inherited uniformly from all Germanic from those shared selectively by North and West Germanic to the exclusion of Gothic.

2.4 A note on the rule names

The CAPR rules implemented in this chapter carry names beginning with PGmc. Those names are intended as stable internal identifiers, not as claims about the precise historical stage of every rule so labelled. A rule named PGmcX may in some cases be a later development that affects only the West Germanic or Northwest Germanic branch; the chapter assignment in this staging map takes priority over the rule-name prefix for historical organization purposes.

3 Proto-Germanic loss of a nasal before *x

3.1 Historical discussion

The oldest change treated in this book is common to the whole family. In the group *-nx- the nasal consonant was lost, the preceding vowel was lengthened in compensation, and that lengthened vowel was nasalized. Its results are shared by every daughter language: Gothic *þeihan*, *brāhta*, *pūhta* stand beside Old High German *dihan*, *brāhta*, *fūht* and Old English *þēon* ‘thrive’, *brōhte* ‘brought’, *pūhte* ‘seemed’, *fūht* ‘damp’ (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1; Ringe 2017, 149–50, §3.2.7). Because no daughter keeps the nasal, the change belongs to Proto-Germanic itself, and it precedes every Northwest Germanic, West Germanic, North Sea Germanic and Anglo-Frisian development described in the chapters that follow.

Only *a, *i and *u occur in this position. Germanic had already raised *e to *i and *o to *u before a nasal followed by a consonant, so the mid vowels are absent from the input (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1).

The vowel that the change creates is long and nasalized, and it is not yet rounded. Fulk emphasizes that the lengthened vowels remained nasalized for a considerable time, well past the close of the Northwest Germanic period, since the nasalized low vowel produced in this way went on to develop to *ō* in Anglo-Frisian and did not fall together with the Old English *ā* that came from *ai (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1). The comparative material makes the same point directly: Gothic, Old Norse, Old High German and Old Saxon all reflect the Proto-Germanic nasalized low vowel as unrounded *ā*, and only Old English and Old Frisian show *ō* (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11). Ringe describes Proto-Germanic *hanhaną as *[xāxaną] and observes that its low vowel was rounded, along with the other nasalized low vowels, in the northernmost West Germanic dialects (Ringe 2017, 149–50, §3.2.7). That rounding is a separate and much later change, and it is treated in the chapter on the rounding of the long nasalized low vowel.

3.2 SC103. Proto-Germanic nasal loss before x (PGmcNasalLossBeforeX)

```
define PGmcNasalLossBeforeX [  
  {*a} -> {*ā} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x},  
  {*i} -> {*ī} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x},  
  {*u} -> {*ū} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x},  
  {*á} -> {*ā} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x},  
  {*í} -> {*ī} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x},  
  {*ú} -> {*ū} || _ EnglishStarNasal {*x}  
] .o. [  
  EnglishStarNasal -> Ø || _ {*x}  
];
```

The rule performs the three parts of the change together: it lengthens the vowel, it marks the lengthened low vowel as nasalized, and it then removes the conditioning nasal. The low vowel is written *ā and the high vowels are written *ī and *ū, because the nasality of the high vowels has no further consequence: they go on to develop exactly as the inherited long *ī and *ū do (Campbell 1959, 47, §121). The nasality of the low vowel is carried forward because its later fate depends on it.

The corpus witnesses both branches of the rule. The high branch is *fúnxstiz ‘fist’, which becomes *fūxsti and, after the loss of *x before the cluster in SC028 PNWGmcPreconsonantalXLoss, gives Old English *fȳst* ‘fist’. The long vowel of Old High German *fūst*, Dutch *vuist* and German *Faust* shows that the word belongs here and to no later law (Kroonen 2013, 160). The rule also supplies the *xst cluster on which the loss of *x before a consonant operates, so the two stand in a feeding relation.

The low branch is *θánxtē, the preterite of the verb ‘to think’, whose principal parts are reconstructed as *þankijaną, *þanhtē, *þanhtaz with the nasal still standing before the fricative (Ringe 2017, 281; 2017, 136). Here the rule yields *θāxtē, and the nasalized low vowel is later rounded by

SC104 EAFNasalizedLowRounding to give Old English *pōhte* ‘thought’. This is the form the handbooks themselves cite for the Anglo-Frisian rounding of the vowel produced here (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1). It does not enter the loss of *x before a consonant, in which respect it differs from ‘fist’, so the fricative survives to the surface and the word displays the vowel history alone.

4 Chapter 2. From Proto-Northwest Germanic to Proto-West Germanic

4.1 Historical interval

This chapter covers the sound changes that took place in the proto-language shared by the West Germanic languages — Old English, Old Frisian, Old Saxon, Old High German, and Old Dutch — before the individual languages diverged. The starting reconstruction is Proto-Northwest Germanic (PNWGmc), the hypothetical common ancestor of North Germanic and West Germanic together; the ending reconstruction is Proto-West Germanic (PWGmc), the immediate common ancestor of the West Germanic languages specifically.

4.2 Scope and internal diversity

Changes in this chapter are not all equally pan-West-Germanic in scope. They may be grouped broadly as follows:

Northwest Germanic innovations (shared by both North and West Germanic): innovations in the unstressed vowel system, certain final-syllable vowel changes, and selected consonant cluster simplifications. Changes labelled NWGmc in the CAPR rule names fall here, though rule prefixes are not always reliable guides to historical scope.

Proto-West-Germanic innovations (shared within West Germanic but not in North Germanic): the cluster of morphological and phonological changes that distinguish Old English, Old High German, Old Saxon, and Old Frisian from Old Norse. Changes labelled PWGmc in the CAPR rule names generally fall here. They include early apocope rules, certain consonant assimilations, and the West Germanic gemination of consonants before *j.

4.3 Major changes

The chapter opens with the root-noun nominative *-z loss (SC096), the generalization of ending-less nominatives through the athematic consonant stems, complete before Proto-West Germanic: none of the West Germanic daughters shows any ending in this class (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118). It is the earliest of the three historically distinct final-*z developments; the other two (SC020 and SC097) open Chapter 3.

The unstressed *ai > *ē development (SC014) represents one of the most pervasive shared NW–West Germanic vowel shifts, turning unstressed endings such as the dative singular and strong-adjective plural to longer vowels. Ringe and Taylor treat this as one of the clearest post-PNWGmc shared developments (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 40–41); Fulk groups it among the North/West-Germanic shared innovations that distinguish the period from Gothic (Fulk 2018, sect. 5.2). The corresponding stressed monophthongization (SC004) belongs later in the cascade and is treated in Chapter 3.

The West Germanic consonant changes of this chapter — j-gemination (SC010), early i-apocope (SC006), coronal-w assimilation (SC008), and related rules — represent the most productive phonological territory for the CAPR derivations. They feed a large proportion of the distinctive consonant clusters of Old English. Handbooks vary in exactly how they group and name these changes (Campbell 1959, sects 404, 406; Hogg 1992, sect. 7.1).

The nasal spirant corridor (SC026–SC027), treated in Chapter 3 at its cascade position, illustrates a type of change common in historical grammars of the “Ingvaemonic” or “North Sea Germanic” area: nasals disappear before voiceless fricatives, with compensatory vowel lengthening (Campbell 1959, sects 462–463; Hogg 1992, sect. 7.77). The CAPR model splits this into two ordered steps to make the vowel effect computationally tractable; the book prose explains that split against the handbook tradition, which typically presents the change as a single process.

Chapters in this part of the book follow the executable cascade order, which models the reconstructed chronology itself. Several rules that carry PWGmc labels — final bare-*a loss (SC041), surviving bimoric *ō unrounding (SC042), and Sievers-law syncope (SC050) — execute later in

the cascade and are therefore presented in Chapter 4, where their individual sections discuss their historical stage labels. Conversely, one rule with a West Saxon label, the palatal-glide rule (SC016), is an orthographic rule of the written surface: it executes after the Old English orthography stage and is presented in Chapter 5.

One historically Proto-Germanic change, Gm-simplification (SC002 PGmcGmSimplification), precedes everything in this chapter as a support stage of the cascade. It is documented in the book-entry plan and its literature dossier confirms the source base is narrow (two lexical families: **draugma*- ‘dream’ and **taugma*- ‘team’; (Kroonen 2013, 101, 511)). A reader-facing section for SC002 awaits a stronger explanatory source base and is not yet assembled in the reader-facing sequence.

4.4 A note on source terminology and subgrouping

The literature uses several partly overlapping stage labels for this period:

- Northwest Germanic: the node uniting North and West Germanic.
- Proto-West Germanic: the node uniting only the West Germanic languages.
- North Sea Germanic or Ingvaeonic: a proposed subgroup within West Germanic covering Old English, Old Frisian, and Old Saxon (and sometimes Old Low Franconian), sharing certain innovations over a broader area.
- Anglo-Frisian: a narrower proposed subgroup linking only Old English and Old Frisian.

These labels are not always used consistently across sources. Ringe and Taylor are cautious about reconstructing a discrete Proto-West-Germanic node (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 50–55). Campbell notes that many of the “West Germanic” shared features could alternatively be treated as parallel developments rather than common inheritance (Campbell 1959, sects 1–5).

CAPR uses PWGmc and NWGmc as organizing labels for this chapter without claiming to have settled all questions about West Germanic subgrouping. Changes that appear in the literature under “Ingvaeonic” labels but affect the Old English-to-Proto-Germanic derivation chain are treated here as late expressions of the same West Germanic developmental period unless existing CAPR dossier research specifically argues for Anglo-Frisian or English-specific placement.

4.5 Rule names

The CAPR rules in this chapter carry names beginning with NWGmc or PWGmc. These names are stable internal identifiers. A name beginning with NWGmc does not guarantee that the change is exclusive to Northwest Germanic, and a name beginning with PWGmc does not guarantee that it is absent from North Germanic. The historical analysis in each sound-change section takes priority over the name prefix.

5 Root-noun nominative *-z loss

5.1 Historical discussion

The athematic consonant stems — the “root nouns” of the handbooks — attached the nominative-singular marker directly to a consonant-final root, and the Proto-Germanic outcome of that collision is genuinely uncertain. Ringe gives the consonant-stem nominative ending as zero, *-z, or possibly *-s, and states plainly that the distribution is unrecoverable for monosyllabic stems (Ringe 2017, 306, §4.3.4). His own paradigm tables carry the uncertainty into print: the nominative of ‘foot’ appears as “fōts? (fōs?)”, while ‘mouse’ is plain **mūs*, its expected extra sibilant already absorbed by degemination (Ringe 2017, 149, 313). Ringe and Taylor repeat the same three-way agnosticism — the root-noun nominative “either ended in *-s or *-z, or was ending-less” (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 28, §2.3.1).

The dictionary traditions encode this situation in different notations, and the differences are conventions of citation rather than competing claims of fact. Orel prints morphologically explicit nominatives with final -z across the whole class: **bōkz* ‘book’, **gansz* ‘goose’, **lūsz* ‘louse’ (Orel

2003, 52, 126, 252). Kroonen cites the same words as bare stems or endingless forms, **bōk-* and **gans-* (Kroonen 2013, 71–72, 168–69), and Kluge/Seebold print a third variant with voiceless -s, as in **bōks* ‘Buch’ (Kluge 2011, 158). Bammesberger shows why the marker is nonetheless real: for voiced-final stems the overt nominative **-z* is positively reconstructible — **burgz* (Gothic *baúrgs*), **frijōndz* (Gothic *frijonds*) — even though **fōt-z* is “phonotaktisch kaum denkbar”, and in West Germanic the ending simply “fiel es ab” (Bammesberger 1990, 190–92, §8.2.3.1). CAPR retains Orel’s morphologically explicit forms as its inputs precisely because they record the inflectional marker whose fate this rule describes.

The three focal words are only superficially parallel. The root-final *s* of ‘louse’ is itself an extension of **luw-* on the model of ‘mouse’ (Bammesberger 1990, 195, §8.3). For ‘goose’, Szemerényi’s lengthening would give a Proto-Indo-European nominative **ǵʰanss* > **ǵʰān*, after which the Proto-Germanic nominative was rebuilt with a final voiced sibilant, **ganz*, reanalyzed within the paradigm (Bammesberger 1990, 196, §8.3; Kroonen 2013, 168–69). ‘Book’ preserves a plain obstruent-final root. What unites them is not a single phonetic history but membership in a paradigm class that generalized the endingless nominative.

The branch evidence dates and localizes that generalization. Gothic keeps its sibilant throughout the class (*baúrgs*, *nahts*, *reiks*) (Fulk 2018, 165–66, §§7.26–7.27). Old Norse redistributes the ending morphologically: masculine root nouns keep *-r* (*fótr*), feminines are endingless (*nótt*, *geit*), while the vocalic-stem feminines *kýr*, *sýr*, *ær* retain *-r* from **-z* with R-umlaut (Fulk 2018, 167, §7.28; Bammesberger 1990, 192–93). West Germanic alone is uniform: there was “no ending in PWGmc, as none of the daughters exhibits any” (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118, §3.4). Fulk supplies the mechanism: Szemerényi’s law removed the nominative sibilant after sonorant-final stems, and endinglessness then spread analogically through the class (Fulk 2018, 143, §7.2). The development is therefore best understood as a morphological generalization enacted differently in each branch — absolute in West Germanic, consonant- and gender-conditioned in North Germanic, absent in Gothic — rather than as one exceptionless sound law.

This change is distinct from the two later final-**z* developments. It was complete before Proto-West Germanic, whereas the loss of **-z* in unstressed syllables (SC020 EAffFinalZDeletion) is itself a Proto-West Germanic change: polysyllabic consonant-stem nominatives such as **fadurz* ‘father’ — and, in this corpus, **frijōndz* ‘friend’, **melukz* ‘milk’, and **mēnōþz* ‘month’ — kept their ending into Proto-West Germanic and lost it there in an unstressed syllable (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). The still later northern loss of **-z* in stressed monosyllables (SC097 MonosyllabicFinalZLoss) affects vowel-final monosyllables like **hwaz* and does not touch the consonant-final root nouns at all, whose ending was gone long before.

5.2 SC096. Root-noun nominative **-z* loss (RootNounNomZLoss)

```
define RootNounNomZLoss [{*z} -> 0 ||
  .#. [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]*
    EnglishStarVocalic+
    [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ .#.];
```

The rule deletes word-final **z* after a consonant in a monosyllable. Three claims of different kinds meet here and must be kept apart. The historical claim is morphological: the nominative-singular ending was lost in the athematic root-noun class, so that this one paradigm cell came to lack its marker — a development complete before Proto-West Germanic (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118, §3.4). The lexical claim belongs to the dictionaries: Orel’s citation forms, which supply the corpus inputs, print that marker explicitly as *-z* in **bōkz*, **flauxz*, **gansz*, and **lūsz* (Orel 2003, 52, 105, 126, 252). The executable statement is neither of these but a computational proxy for them: ‘delete word-final **z* after a consonant in a monosyllable’. It is not proposed as a Proto-Germanic sound law; it earns its place only because every form the corpus submits to the morphological development is a consonant-final monosyllable, so the narrow phonological statement covers the class exactly. Four corpus derivations witness the rule, each yielding its expected Old English outcome: PGmc **bōkz* ‘book’ yields OE *bōc* ‘book’, **gánsz* ‘goose’ yields *gōs* ‘goose’, **lūsz* ‘louse’ yields *lūs* ‘louse’, and **flāuxz* ‘flea’ yields *flēah* ‘flea’. Should the corpus ever acquire a consonant-final monosyllable in **-z* that is not a root-noun nominative, the proxy and the morphology would

come apart, and the rule would need to be re-scoped; the project’s regression tests pin the firing population to exactly these four words so that any fifth firing forces that adjudication rather than passing silently.

The rule applies at the head of the English line, before SC009 PWGmcIjContraction. That ordering is fixed by the identity of the process rather than by a wrong form: contraction turns the polysyllabic **frījōndz* ‘friend’ into a monosyllable, and if the root-noun rule applied after contraction it would capture **friundz* — yet the ending of ‘friend’ survived into Proto-West Germanic and fell in an unstressed syllable, the change described under SC020 EAffFinalZDeletion (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). Because both rules delete the same segment, moving this rule later changes no Old English output; the early placement keeps the derivation of ‘friend’ aligned with the historical account rather than with an accident of the cascade.

Negative controls behave as the morphology predicts. Stressed monosyllables whose **z* follows a vowel — the domain of the later northern change — do not meet the post-consonantal environment. Medial **z* is untouched and remains available for rhotacism (SC003 EAFRhotacism): PGmc **déuzq* ‘deer’ still yields OE *dēor* ‘deer’ with its rhotacized medial consonant.

6 Early unstressed vowel changes

6.1 Historical discussion

The first change monophthongizes unstressed **ai*; the second carries early unstressed front-vowel leveling farther in forms such as *weorold* ‘world’. Both have a diagnostic later boundary in the dataset.

6.2 Historical discussion of unstressed **ai* monophthongization

Ringe and Taylor describe the broad Northwest Germanic reduction of unstressed **ai* to a long mid vowel that merges with unstressed **e*, in final and nonfinal syllables alike (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 37–41). Two dative-singular endings in the dataset, span **spánnai* ‘span’ and meed **mízdai* ‘meed’, carry the change. The stressed development of **ái* to **ā* is treated separately as SC004 EAFaiMonophthongization.

6.3 SC014. Monophthongization of unstressed **ai* (PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization)

```
define PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization [  
  {*ai} -> {*ē}  
];
```

The dative-singular endings span **spánnai* ‘span’ and meed **mízdai* ‘meed’ carry this change; both give a final **ē*. If SC014 PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization is delayed until after SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, the **ē* is no longer present for shortening, so PGmc **spánnai* ‘span’ yields *†spannē* rather than expected OE *spanne* ‘span’. This shows that SC014 PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization must come before SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening in the modeled sequence.

Ringe and Taylor’s merger of unstressed **ai* with long mid **ē* establishes the historical development, in final and nonfinal syllables alike. The stressed development of **ái* to **ā* is a separate and later change; see SC004 EAFaiMonophthongization.

6.4 Historical discussion of early unstressed front-vowel leveling

Campbell treats the merger of unstressed front vowels directly and also records the variation of *weorold* ‘world’ and *weoruld* ‘world’ (Campbell 1959, 141–42, 154–55). These forms supply SC015 PNWGmcILowering with a firmer lexical basis than the preceding change.

6.5 SC015. Leveling of early unstressed front vowels (PNWGmcILowering)

```
define PNWGmcILowering [  
  {*i} -> {*e}  
  || .#. EnglishStarNonVelarConsonant* _  
    EnglishStarCoronal+ EnglishStarNonHighVowel,  
  {*í} -> {*é}  
  || .#. EnglishStarNonVelarConsonant* _  
    EnglishStarCoronal+ EnglishStarNonHighVowel  
];
```

The *weorold* ‘world’ and *weoruld* ‘world’ variants turn the general source claim into an ordering test. If SC015 PNWGmcILowering is delayed until after SC036 OEInterStressRaising, PGmc **wír-àldu* ‘world’ yields *†wuruld* rather than expected OE *weorold* ‘world’; earlier movement changes no output.

The derivation thus fixes front-vowel leveling before interstress raising while leaving its earlier boundary open.

SC016 OEWsPalatalGlide and SC017 PNWGmcULowering follow with a more tightly constrained local chronology.

7 Unstressed **a*-raising before final **m*

7.1 Historical discussion

Campbell notes that unstressed *u* is especially well preserved before *m*, with dat.pl. *-um* and related endings as the clearest evidence (Campbell 1959, 156, §373). Fulk likewise includes the development of early unstressed **o* to *u* before *m* among the similarities shared by North and West Germanic (Fulk 2018, 16, §5.2).

I restrict the change to unstressed vowels in inflectional material because the strongest evidence concerns noninitial unstressed material before final **m*. Final **m* conditions the raising.

7.2 SC005. Unstressed **a*-raising before final **m* (PNWGmcAToUBeforeM)

```
define PNWGmcAToUBeforeM [  
  {*a} -> {*u} || EnglishStarVocalic EnglishStarConsonant+ _ {*m} ({*i})?  
  ↪ ({*z})? .#.  
];
```

Here the witness word and the comparative evidence serve different purposes. If raising is delayed until after SC017 PNWGmcULowering, PGmc **skúldramiz* ‘shoulders’ yields *†scoldrum* rather than expected OE *sculdrum* ‘shoulders’; earlier placements converge on the expected output. The scope of the change is established by inflectional evidence across multiple paradigm types: a-stem dative plural ON *dǫgum* ‘days’, OE *dagum* ‘days’, OS *dagun* ‘days’, OHG *tagum* ‘days’, beside Gothic *dagam* ‘days’; strong-adjective dative singular ON *góðum* ‘good’, OE *gōdum* ‘good’, OS *gōdum* ‘good’, beside Gothic *godamma* ‘good’ (OS also shows variant forms *gōdumu* and *-un*); and first-plural present ON *berum* ‘we carry’, OHG *berumēs* ‘we carry’, beside Gothic *baíram* ‘we carry’. Across these sets, North/West Germanic shows unstressed *-um* where Gothic preserves *-am*. The derivation of *sculdrum* ‘shoulders’ supplies a CAPR ordering witness for the relative chronology, but the cognate set for ‘shoulder’ does not contribute comparative evidence for the rule’s historical scope.

8 Northwest Germanic lowering of long $\bar{e}$

8.1 Historical discussion

Proto-Germanic $*\bar{e}_1$ (the long mid vowel of PIE origin, as against the later $*\bar{e}_2$) split East Germanic from the rest of the family: Gothic keeps a mid vowel, written $\bar{e}$, in *gadēps* ‘deed’, *slēpan* ‘to sleep’, *mēna* ‘moon’, and *jēr* ‘year’, while Norse and all of West Germanic show a low vowel — Old Norse *ráða*, *láta*, *ár*, *nál*, Old High German *tāt*, *slāfan*, *jār*, *māno*, Old Saxon *dād*, *slāpan*, *jār*. Ringe and Taylor assemble the comparative set and reconstruct a Northwest Germanic sound change $*\bar{e}_1 > *\bar{a}$ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 11–13). The change is directly dated by the earliest epigraphy: the Early Runic accusative *mākija* ‘sword’ (beside Gothic *mēkeis*) already shows $\bar{a}$ in the second half of the second century AD (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 12), and the a-rune likewise writes the stressed reflex in the Opedal stone’s *swestar* ‘sister’, with early Proto-Scandinavian loans into Sami confirming the /a:/ value (Stiles 2017, 4).

The change affected stressed syllables only. Ringe and Taylor restrict it explicitly: unstressed $*\bar{e}$ did not lower but was eventually shortened, as in $*fadēr > *fader$ ‘father’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 13, and p. 147); in the runic material the unstressed final vowel of *fapir* has already merged with $*i$ (Stiles 2017, 4). Within stressed syllables, however, the lowering was unconditioned: it applied before nasals exactly as elsewhere, and Ringe and Taylor accordingly print the intermediates $*mānō$ ‘moon’, $*mānōþ$ ‘month’, and $*spānuz$ ‘spoon’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 11). The later, dialectally narrower fates of this $*\bar{a}$ — fronting in the North Sea area when oral, rounding when nasalized — are separate sound changes treated in their own chapters.

The reconstruction of the intermediate value is disputed. The objection is an old one: Bennett observed that the received account obliges Gothic to move $\bar{e}$ to $\bar{æ}$ and back to $\bar{e}$, and the non-West-Saxon dialects and Old Frisian to run through $\bar{e} > \bar{æ} > \bar{a} > \bar{æ} > \bar{e}$, “with no apparent agreement among the languages and no discernible phonological trend”, and that the Proto-Germanic $\bar{æ}$ is on that account preserved directly nowhere (Bennett 1950, 232–33, 235). In its place he proposed that the backing to $\bar{a}$ began in the north of the Germanic homeland and spread southward, never reaching Gothic in the east or Anglian and Frisian in the west, so that West Saxon $\bar{æ}$ is a retention of the intermediate stage rather than a re-fronting (Bennett 1950, 234–35). Fulk argues in the same direction on modern evidence: the Northwest Germanic vowel was a low front $*\bar{æ}$, retained unchanged in Anglo-Frisian, with the backing to $\bar{a}$ of Norse and inner West Germanic a separate areal development spreading northward from Upper German territory; on that reading the runic $\bar{a}$ spellings write a front [æ:] for which the futhark had no better grapheme (Fulk 2018, 60–61, §4.6). Campbell is deliberately noncommittal, finding the $*\bar{a}$ stage “tempting to assume, though not definitely demonstrable” (Campbell 1959, 50–51, §§128–129). Ringe and Taylor answer with the lengthened place-adverbs *pār* ‘there’ and *hwær* ‘where’, whose front vowels are most naturally the output of fronting applied to a back $*\bar{a}$ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 13–14). The present model adopts the two-step reconstruction while recording that the alternative remains live. Campbell is deliberately noncommittal, finding the $*\bar{a}$ stage “tempting to assume, though not definitely demonstrable” (Campbell 1959, 50–51, §§128–129). Ringe and Taylor answer with the lengthened place-adverbs *pār* ‘there’ and *hwær* ‘where’, whose front vowels are most naturally the output of fronting applied to a back $*\bar{a}$ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 13–14). The present model adopts the two-step reconstruction while recording that the alternative remains live.

8.2 SC024. Lowering of stressed long $\bar{e}$ (PNWGmcLongELowering)

```
define PNWGmcLongELowering [  
  {*\bar{e}} -> {*\bar{a}}  
];
```

The rule reads the stressed tier $*\bar{e}$ only, in keeping with the stress restriction; unstressed $*\bar{e}$, as in **fadēr* ‘father’, is left for the unstressed-shortening rules of the Old English stage and never lowers. No segmental environment is imposed: nasal forms such as **mēnōþz* ‘month’ and **spēnuz* ‘spoon’ pass through $*mānōþ$ - and $*spānuz$ on their way to *mōnaþ* and *spōn*, exactly as reconstructed by Ringe and Taylor (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 11).

The rule stands near the head of the cascade, before the genuinely West Germanic innovations such as early *i*-apocope, **ij*-contraction, and *j*-gemination — the placement follows from the dating: the second-century runic evidence puts the lowering among the earliest Northwest Germanic developments, well before the changes that separate West Germanic from Norse. Its output **ā* is consumed much later in the cascade by SC102 EAFHiatusWInsertion, SC025 EAFLongANasalRounding, and SC101 EAFLongAFronting: if the lowering is instead displaced after those rules, **ménōθz* yields *†mānaþ* rather than OE *mōnaþ* ‘month’, **sképq* yields *†scāp* rather than *scēap* ‘sheep’, and **séanq* ‘to sow’ never acquires the hiatus-filling *w* of *sāwan*. Within the cascade no earlier boundary has been demonstrated; the second-century runic attestation supplies the absolute dating.

9 Early i-apocope

9.1 Historical discussion

Sievers/Brunner treats the early loss of final **i* after unstressed syllables as established by the fact that these endings no longer trigger later i-umlaut in Old English, and Ringe and Taylor make the same point through the pathway to *geogub* ‘youth’ (Brunner 1965, sects 145–146; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 141). Campbell’s *dugup* ‘troop’ and *geogup* ‘youth’ examples belong to the same pattern (Campbell 1959, sect. 332).

The ending vowel disappears in a weak suffixal environment early enough to block later umlaut. This anti-umlaut chronology distinguishes the change from later final-vowel losses.

9.2 SC006. Early i-apocope (PWGmcEarlyIApocope)

```
define PWGmcEarlyIApocope [  
  {*i} -> Ø || PGmcStarStressedVowel PGmcStarConsonant+ PGmcStarVocalic  
  ⇨ PGmcStarConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*i} -> Ø || PGmcStarStressedVowel PGmcStarConsonant+ PGmcStarVocalic  
  ⇨ PGmcStarConsonant+ _ {*z} .#.  
];
```

The absence of umlaut in *geogub* ‘youth’ provides the historical argument for early deletion. The ordered derivation supplies a different test: if apocope is delayed until after SC034 OEAwLong-Diphthong, PGmc **skáwōθi* ‘shows’ yields *†scēawep* rather than expected OE *scēawap* ‘shows’.

Early i-apocope must therefore precede the long-diphthong development. Moving it earlier within the tested range leaves every output unchanged; its early date rests on the anti-umlaut evidence, not on a lower boundary supplied by the witness words.

10 Final *ō-lowering before *r

10.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor separate two points here: a broader shortening of vowels before word-final *r in unstressed syllables (for which kinship *r-stems such as PGmc *fader > PWGmc *fader are a key diagnostic), and the specific *ō-before-*r development needed here (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 58–59). The direct lexical witnesses for *ō in that environment are two independent etyma: PGmc *fedwōr ‘four’ with WGmc reflexes OE *fēower* ‘four’, OFris *fiuwer* ‘four’, OS *fiuwar* ‘four’; and PGmc *watōr ‘water’ with OE *wæter* ‘water’.

The rule is historically secure but narrow: final or pre-final *ō before word-final *r. The clearest evidence remains concentrated in the four and water material. No broader environment for *ō is attested.

10.2 SC007. Lowering of final bimoric *ō before *r (PWGmcFinalOrLowering)

```
define PWGmcFinalOrLowering [  
  { *ō } -> { *a } || _ { *r } .#.  
];
```

OE *wæter* ‘water’ reveals why lowering must precede SC043 EAFBrightening. If SC007 PWGmcFinalOrLowering is delayed until afterwards, PGmc *wātōr ‘water’ yields [†]*water* rather than expected OE *wæter* ‘water’: brightening can affect the vowel only after lowering has created its input. Moving the change earlier within the tested range alters no output.

The witness thus supplies a terminus ante quem at brightening but no earlier boundary. Comparative support for the *ō-before-*r rule comes from the two lexical witnesses *fedwōr ‘four’ and *watōr ‘water’ and their WGmc reflexes; kinship *r-stems belong to the broader pre-*r shortening context, not to a direct *ō > *a control. Within CAPR, *wæter* ‘water’ is the form that establishes ordering before brightening. No broader lowering of *ō is attested.

11 Coronal-w assimilation

11.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor treat the assimilation of **dw* and **zw* to **ww* as a shared Proto-West-Germanic innovation supported by one example of each input cluster (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 56–57; Stiles 1985, 89–94). The **dw* example is the numeral ‘four’: PGmc **feðwor* (Gothic *fidwor*) → WGmc **fewwar* → OE *fēower*, Old Frisian *fiuwer*, Old Saxon *fiuwar*. The **zw* example is the second-person plural pronoun, where two oblique case forms show the change: acc./dat. PGmc **izwiz* (Gothic *izwis*) → OE *eow*, Old Frisian *iu*, Old Saxon *iu*, OHG *iu*; and gen. Ringe and Taylor’s PGmc **izweraz* (Gothic *izwara*) → OE *eower*, OHG *iuwer* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 56). Stiles discusses the same pronominal material using his own reconstruction conventions and explicitly treats Gothic *izwara* among the relevant comparanda (Stiles 1985, 89–94). These two case forms belong to a single pronominal paradigm, not to two independent etyma.

The historical support rests on a small witness set. Both coronal inputs assimilate before **w*, but the evidence for each cluster is confined: the numeral alone supplies the **dw* instance, and the oblique case forms of the second-person plural pronoun supply the **zw* instance. Both clusters are now witnessed in the corpus: ‘four’ for **dw*, and ‘you’ — selected in its dat.(-acc.) plural cell **izwiz* — for **zw*, deriving through **iwwi*, apocopated **iww*, to OE *ēow* ‘you’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, §3.1.1; Fulk 2018, sect. 8.3, pp. 204–205).

11.2 SC008. Assimilation of coronal consonants before **w* (PWGmcCoronalWAssimilation)

```
define PWGmcCoronalWAssimilation [  
  {*d} -> {*w} || - {*w},  
  {*z} -> {*w} || - {*w}  
];
```

OE *fēower* ‘four’ exposes a feeding relation: coronal assimilation must create **ww* while simplification can still reduce it. If SC008 PWGmcCoronalWAssimilation is delayed until after SC031 OEWWsimplification, PGmc **fedwōr* ‘four’ yields *†fēowwer* rather than expected OE *fēower* ‘four’. Earlier placements alter no output.

The numeral fixes that relative order. The pronoun now fixes a second one: assimilation must precede rhotacism (SC003 EAFRhotacism). The **z* of **izwiz* stands between vowel and **w*; had rhotacism applied first, it would have produced *†irwiz*, from which OE *ēow* ‘you’ can never be derived. The executable cascade composes the assimilation well before rhotacism, and the corpus derivation of *ēow* ‘you’ fails if the two are reversed. ‘Four’ remains the sole **dw* witness and the sole source of the coronal-assimilation → *ww*-simplification ordering constraint. The earlier boundary of the assimilation remains undetermined.

12 *ij*-contraction in *friend*

12.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor describe a change of **ijo* to **iu* in the ancestor of *friend*, with the pathway PGmc **frijōnd-* (Gothic *frijonds*) → PWGmc **friund* → OE *frēond*, Old Frisian *frīund*, Old Saxon *friund*, Old High German *friunt* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 62). The same source immediately warns that the **ijo* sequence is unique enough that wider generalization is inadvisable (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 62). Luick (printed p. 118) notes that *iu* generalised within several *j*-stem paradigms through a related but differently conditioned loss of *j*, but does not supply a second example of the exact stressed **ijo* sequence (Luick 1914–1940, 118).

The change concerns a rare sequence attested only in the **frijōnd-* etymon and cannot safely be generalized into a broadly productive rule.

12.2 SC009. *ij*-contraction in *friend* (PWGmcIjContraction)

```
define PWGmcIjContraction [  
  {*i} {*j} {*ō} -> {*iu} || _ EnglishStarConsonant,  
  {*ī} {*j} {*ō} -> {*īu} || _ EnglishStarConsonant  
];
```

Only the **frijōnd-* etymon tests this contraction. If the rare **ijō* sequence survives until after SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling, PGmc **frijōndz* ‘friend’ yields *†friund* rather than expected OE *frēond* ‘friend’; moving contraction earlier within the tested range changes no output.

That single contrast places SC009 PWGmcIjContraction before diphthong leveling but gives no lower boundary. It cannot establish a productive sound law beyond the **frijōnd-* etymon, precisely the reservation made by Ringe and Taylor.

13 West Germanic j-gemination

13.1 Historical discussion

Fulk treats West Germanic consonant gemination before *j after a short vowel as a regular development and illustrates it with forms such as OE *settan* ‘set’ and *lecgan* ‘lay’ (Fulk 2018, 127, §6.15).

The change applies specifically after a short vowel before *j, not to geminate consonants generally.

13.2 SC010. West Germanic j-gemination (PWGmcJGemination)

```
define PWGmcJGemination [  
  {*p} -> {*p} {*p} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*b} -> {*b} {*b} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*t} -> {*t} {*t} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*d} -> {*d} {*d} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*k} -> {*k} {*k} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*g} -> {*g} {*g} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*f} -> {*f} {*f} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*s} -> {*s} {*s} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*m} -> {*m} {*m} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*n} -> {*n} {*n} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*l} -> {*l} {*l} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*ŋ} -> {*ŋ} {*ŋ} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j},  
  {*x} -> {*x} {*x} || EnglishStarShortVowel _ {*j}  
];
```

OE *nett* ‘net’ fixes the order because the syllabic-*j* development would remove the glide that conditions gemination. If SC011 PWGmcSyllabicJ precedes SC010 PWGmcJGemination, PGmc **nátjɑ* ‘net’ yields [†]*nete* rather than expected OE *nett* ‘net’. Earlier movement of gemination changes no output.

The chronology is phonologically transparent: the consonant must geminate before *j ceases to be consonantal. The witness establishes no earlier boundary.

14 Syllabic j after final-vowel loss

14.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor state directly that after final unstressed **a* and **ą* were lost, postconsonantal **j* became syllabic **i*, with outcomes behind OE *here* ‘army’ and *rice* ‘kingdom’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 46).

The sources establish the development, although the lexical evidence supplies little independent support for its position. Its scope is postconsonantal *j*, not high-vowel vocalization generally.

14.2 SC011. Syllabic **j* after final-vowel loss (PWGmcSyllabicJ)

```
define PWGmcSyllabicJ [  
  {*j} {*a} -> {*i} || EnglishStarShortVowel EnglishStarConsonant _ .#.,  
  {*j} {*ą} -> {*i} || EnglishStarShortVowel EnglishStarConsonant _ .#.  
];
```

The same PGmc **nátją* ‘net’ witness supplies the only firm boundary. Placing SC011 PWGmcSyllabicJ before SC010 PWGmcJGeminatio yields [†]*nete* rather than expected OE *nett* ‘net’; moving it later changes no output.

Comparative evidence establishes postconsonantal **j* to syllabic **i* after final unstressed **a* or **ą* loss, with *here* ‘army’ and *rice* ‘kingdom’ as outcomes. The lexicon adds only that vocalization followed gemination, not where it falls among subsequent changes.

15 Simplification of the cluster *xs before a consonant

15.1 Historical discussion

The change treated here is narrow. When *x stood before *s and that *s was itself followed by a further consonant, the *x was lost and the cluster was reduced. Campbell states the rule in exactly these terms, that when a consonant follows, *xs becomes s, and he illustrates it with *wæstm* ‘growth’ and *wæsma* beside *weaxan* ‘to grow’, and with Northumbrian *sesta* ‘sixth’ beside West Saxon *siexta* (Campbell 1959, 170, §417). Brunner gives the same statement and adds that the following consonant may be *j* as well as a true obstruent, citing *nēosian* ‘to visit’, *þīsl* ‘pole’, *wæsma* and *wæstm* (Brunner 1965, 184, §221.2). Bülbring formulates it as a pre-English change and is careful to say that it held as a rule, with exceptions (Bülbring 1902, 215, §527).

The cluster that the change requires is a specific one, and two neighbouring clusters show that the restriction is real. Where *xs stood with no consonant after it, the *x was not lost at all. It survived long enough to cause breaking and then hardened to the sound written *x*, that is [ks], as in *fox* ‘fox’, *siex* ‘six’, *weaxan*, *oxa* ‘ox’ and *fleax* ‘flax’ (Campbell 1959, 170, §416). Where *x stood before a single consonant it was likewise kept. Campbell observes that once *xs had become [ks], the only group in which *x still stood before a voiceless consonant in earliest Old English was *xt, and that this group remained, as in *feohtan* ‘to fight’, *miht* ‘might’, *niht* ‘night’ and *sōhte* ‘sought’ (Campbell 1959, 186, §464). The contrast is attested outside English as well. Old High German and Old Saxon *lastar* ‘reproach’ comes from **laxstra-* with the *x lost before *st, while Old English *leahtor* comes from **laxtra-* with the *x kept before *t (Campbell 1959, 170, §417).

The change is not Proto-Germanic. Gothic keeps the *h of this cluster in *bi-niuhsjan* ‘to spy out’ and *saihsta* ‘sixth’, so the loss must be later than the separation of Gothic (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 157–58). Campbell reports the loss from the whole West Germanic area and from North Germanic as well, citing Old Norse *ísl* ‘axle’ and *nýsa*, Old Saxon *weslon* ‘to exchange’, *wastum* ‘growth’ and *niustan*, and Old High German *niusen* ‘to try’ (Campbell 1959, 170, §417). Ringe and Taylor set out the same comparative material and reach a more guarded conclusion. They derive Proto-Germanic **niuhsijaną* through Proto-West Germanic **niusjan* to Old English *nēosan*, and **sehstō* to Northumbrian *sesta*, and they take the Old Saxon agreement in *wastum*, *thisla* and *niusian* to show a shared northern West Germanic change. Against that they weigh the competition between *þixl* and *þīsl* in early Mercian, the survival of *x in *eaxl* ‘shoulder’ from **ahslu*, and the retention in Old High German *sehsto* and *dihsala*. Their conclusion is that the *h was lost, possibly variably and possibly only in some dialects, when two or more consonants followed, and that the loss may have been in part a parallel development in the diverging Northwest Germanic dialects (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 157–58). The existence of the change is therefore secure while its exact date and extent are not, and the rating given here reflects that division.

Two chronological anchors are available. Ringe and Taylor place the loss after the Proto-West Germanic syncope of *-*CijV-*, since it is that syncope which brings the *s and the *j of **niuhsjan* together (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 157). They place it before breaking, observing that the undiphthongized vowels of *wæstm* and *þīsl* can be accounted for only by supposing that these *h were lost before breaking took place (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 158). The rule is stated between those two points.

One witness in this collection undergoes the change. Proto-Germanic **funxstiz* ‘fist’ reaches the rule as **fūxstiz*, the long vowel having been produced by the Proto-Germanic loss of a nasal before *x described in SC103 PGmcNasalLossBeforeX. The cluster *xst is then reduced to *st, and the word continues to Old English *fyst* ‘fist’. The comparative set for this particular word is West Germanic throughout, with Old Frisian *fēst*, Old Saxon and Old High German *fūst*, Dutch *vuist* and German *Faust* (Kroonen 2013, 160; Orel 2003, 157). Neither Gothic nor Old Norse preserves a reflex of it, so the word bears on the domain of the change rather than on its date.

The word *thought* is the control. Proto-Germanic **θánxtē* also passes through SC103 PGmcNasal-LossBeforeX, which leaves **θāxtē*, but the *x there stands before a single *t and not before *s, so the present rule does not touch it and Old English has *þōhte* ‘thought’ with its *h* intact. The pair *fist* and *thought* reproduces within this collection the same contrast that *lastar* and *leahtor* show across the West Germanic languages.

The relation between the two rules should not be overstated. The earlier rule does supply the cluster that this one simplifies, but the order of the two is established by their stages and not by any word in this collection. If the present rule were stated first, *fist* would still reach *fȳst*, because removing the **x* from **funxstiz* leaves a nasal before *s*, and that nasal is removed with compensatory lengthening by the North Sea Germanic nasal-spirant law. The outcome is overdetermined, and the chronology rests on Gothic *bi-niuhsjan* and *saihsta* instead.

15.2 SC028. Simplification of **xs* before a consonant (PNWGmcPreconsonantalXLoss)

```
define PNWGmcPreconsonantalXLoss [
  {*x} -> 0 || _ {*s} EnglishStarConsonant
];
```

The **s* in the structural description carries the whole weight of the rule. Without it the rule would delete **x* before any two consonants, and it would then wrongly remove the first element of a geminate **xx* before **j*, where Old English in fact has *hliehhan* ‘to laugh’ with the geminate written *hh* (Campbell 1959, 186, §464). The rule fires on *fist* and on no other word in this collection, and it leaves *fox*, *six*, *wax*, *flax* and *ox* untouched, as it must, along with *thought*, *fight*, *night*, *light*, *might*, *knight*, *fright* and *wight*.

The implementation name retains an older description of the rule and will be brought into line in a separate pass.

16 *lp*-voicing

16.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor treat word-internal **lp* > **ld* as a regular sound change in northern West Germanic and illustrate it with forms such as *fealdan* ‘fold’, *beald* ‘bold’, *wuldor* ‘glory’, and *gylden* ‘golden’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170–71). Campbell gives a similar West-Germanic-facing formulation with examples such as *fealdan*, *wuldor*, *beald*, *gold* ‘gold’, and *feld* ‘field’ (Campbell 1959, 169, §414).

The comparative evidence supports *lp* > *ld* most clearly in northern West Germanic, not as an unqualified pan-PWGmc development.

16.2 SC012. Northern West Germanic *lp*-voicing (EAFLThVoicing)

```
define EAFLThVoicing [  
  {*θ} -> {*d} || {*l} _  
];
```

The *field*, *fold*, *gold*, and *wold* families preserve **lp* to **ld*, but none dates the change against a neighboring rule. Every output remains unchanged when the voicing is moved in either direction.

Comparative reconstruction therefore establishes northern West Germanic *lp* > *ld*, but the witness forms fix no date. Neither a pan-PWGmc attribution nor an exact local placement follows from the evidence presented here.

17 Dental hardening

17.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor state directly that in PWGmc voiced dental fricative **ð* became stop **d* in all positions (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 43).

The change is systemic across early West Germanic and extends beyond any one lexical family.

17.2 SC013. Dental hardening (PWGmcDentalHardening)

```
define PWGmcDentalHardening [  
  { *ð } -> { *d }  
];
```

Dental hardening has systemic scope: voiced fricative **ð* became stop **d* throughout early West Germanic. Moving SC013 PWGmcDentalHardening earlier or later changes no output.

Comparative evidence establishes the sound law; the present lexicon leaves its exact position approximate.

18 Northwest Germanic u-lowering

18.1 Historical discussion

Northwest Germanic lowered **u* to **o* when the following syllable contained a non-high vowel. Campbell describes the change and lists *ġeoc* ‘yoke’ among its regular outcomes (Campbell 1959, 42–43, §115); Fulk gives the same word as a standard example — “OIcel. ok, OE *geoc*, OHG *joh* beside *juh* and OS *juk*” — and notes the paradigmatic alternation between lowered and unlowered stems that the conditioning produced (Fulk 2018, 56, §4.3). A word-initial **j* does not block the change: the blocking effect of *j* concerns only a consonantal *j* standing between the target vowel and the conditioning vowel, as in the class I weak verbs of the *cnyssan* ‘strike’ type (Fulk 2018, 56, §4.3). Ringe and Taylor accordingly reconstruct the Proto-West Germanic paradigm of ‘yoke’ with the lowering applied (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 129).

The clearest corpus witnesses are *ġeoc* ‘yoke’, *nosu* ‘nose’, *šcofl* ‘shovel’, and *sorg* ‘sorrow’. Where the following syllable kept a high vowel the lowering did not apply, as in *ġeogub* ‘youth’, whose root *u* survived (Brunner 1965, 64–65, §92.1).

18.2 SC017. Lowering of **u* before following non-high vowels (PNWGmcULowering)

```
define PNWGmcULowering [  
  {*u} -> {*o}  
  || .#. EnglishStarConsonant* _  
    [EnglishStarConsonantNoJ - EnglishStarNasal]  
    EnglishStarConsonantNoJ* EnglishStarNonHighVowel,  
  {*ú} -> {*ó}  
  || .#. EnglishStarConsonant* _  
    [EnglishStarConsonantNoJ - EnglishStarNasal]  
    EnglishStarConsonantNoJ* EnglishStarNonHighVowel  
];
```

Lowering of *u* to *o* is fixed on both sides by *ġeoc* ‘yoke’, *nosu*, *šcofl* ‘shovel’, and *sorg*.

The lowering feeds the much later West Saxon palatal-glide spelling (SC016 OEWsPalatalGlide): the *o* that the scribes wrote in *ġeoc* ‘yoke’ is the output of this change, so PGmc **júkq* ‘yoke’ passes through **jokq* on its way to the attested spelling (Fulk 2018, 56, §4.3; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 129). After SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising, PGmc **núšō* ‘nose’ yields *†nusu* rather than expected *nosu*, PGmc **skúflō* ‘shovel’ yields *†šcufl* rather than expected *šcofl* ‘shovel’, and PGmc **súrgō* ‘sorrow’ yields *†surg* rather than expected *sorg*. These witnesses place SC017 PNWGmcULowering before final long-*o* raising, and the *ġeoc* spelling shows its output surviving into the written record.

19 Stressed monosyllable **ō*-raising

19.1 Historical discussion

Campbell treats the development of final accented *ō* to *ū* in stressed monosyllables directly, with the familiar outcomes behind *cū* ‘cow’, *hū* ‘how’, *tū* ‘two’, and *bū* ‘both’ (Campbell 1959, 47, §122).

The change is historically secure, but the tested forms determine no close relative position for it. Its input is final **ō* in a stressed monosyllable.

19.2 SC018. Raising of final stressed monosyllabic **ō* (PNWGmcStressedMonosyllableORaising)

```
define PNWGmcStressedMonosyllableORaising [  
  {*ō} -> {*ū} || .#. [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]* _ .#.   
];
```

Campbell’s *cū* ‘cow’, *hū* ‘how’, and *tū* ‘two’ establish final stressed monosyllabic **ō* > **ū*.

Reversing SC018 PNWGmcStressedMonosyllableORaising with neighboring changes leaves every output unchanged. The sound change is secure, but its exact position in the early history of long vowels rests on the handbooks.

20 Raising of final unstressed long $\bar{o}$

20.1 Historical discussion

Ringe and Taylor describe the change of unstressed final non-nasalized long $\bar{o}$ to short u as a Northwest Germanic development (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 30). It applies in the same final-syllable environment as the subsequent loss of word-final z . The derivation of *ræste* ‘rest’ fixes their local order: SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising must still see final $\bar{o}$, and word-final z -deletion removes the following z only afterward.

The change supplies the final vowel of forms such as *nosu* ‘nose’, *scōfl* ‘shovel’, and *sorg* ‘sorrow’.

20.2 SC019. Raising of final unstressed long $\bar{o}$ (PNWGmcFinalLongORaising)

```
define PNWGmcFinalLongORaising [  
  { $\bar{o}$ } -> { $u$ }  
  || EnglishStarVocalic  
  [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ .#.  
];
```

Two groups of witnesses confine final unstressed long $\bar{o} > u$. The forms *nosu* ‘nose’, *scōfl* ‘shovel’, and *sorg* ‘sorrow’ fix its lower boundary.

Before SC017 PNWGmcULowering, PGmc $\bar{n}ús\bar{o}$ ‘nose’ yields $^{\dagger}nusu$ rather than expected OE *nosu* ‘nose’, PGmc $\bar{s}kúfl\bar{o}$ ‘shovel’ yields $^{\dagger}scufl$ rather than expected *scōfl* ‘shovel’, and PGmc $\bar{s}úrg\bar{o}$ ‘sorrow’ yields $^{\dagger}surg$ rather than expected *sorg* ‘sorrow’. After word-final z -deletion (SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion), PGmc $\bar{r}ást\bar{o}z$ ‘rest’ yields $^{\dagger}rast$ rather than expected *ræste* ‘rest’. These failures place SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising after u-lowering and before final z-loss.

21 Chapter 3. From Proto-West Germanic to Anglo-Frisian

21.1 Historical interval

This chapter covers the sound changes that occurred after the Proto-West Germanic period and before, or during the emergence of, the specifically English line. The starting reconstruction is Proto-West Germanic; the end point is the Proto-Anglo-Frisian stage — or more precisely, the cluster of innovations that define the English and Frisian branch within West Germanic.

21.2 A necessary terminological caution

The title of this chapter uses “Anglo-Frisian” as an organizing historical concept. That choice requires an explicit qualification.

The scholarly literature uses several overlapping terms for this developmental period:

- North Sea Germanic and Ingvaemonic: labels used by some scholars for a proposed subgroup comprising Old English, Old Frisian, and Old Saxon (or more narrowly, Old English and Old Frisian only). The innovations associated with this label — especially the nasal spirant changes and certain vowel developments — are sometimes described as diffusion rather than shared inheritance (Campbell 1959, sects 1–3).
- Anglo-Frisian: a label used specifically for the Old English / Old Frisian branch, or for innovations shared between the two languages. Its use presupposes a tighter relationship between English and Frisian than between either and Old Saxon.
- Proto-Anglo-Frisian (PAF): the strongest interpretation, positing a discrete reconstructed common ancestor for Old English and Old Frisian specifically. This is the position of Ringe and Taylor, who reconstruct a PAF stage between Proto-West Germanic and Proto-Old-English (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 54–68).

CAPR does not commit to a universally accepted discrete PAF node. The chapter title uses “Anglo-Frisian” because the key changes of this period — especially West Germanic rhotacism (SC003), word-final *z deletion (SC020), and Anglo-Frisian brightening (SC043) — are most prominently associated with that label in the handbook literature. But the analysis does not require that every change passed through a single genealogical PAF stage. Some changes may be West Germanic broadly; others may reflect areal diffusion. The existing CAPR dossiers record the source-by-source picture where these distinctions matter.

21.3 Major changes and their historical basis

21.3.1 West Germanic rhotacism (SC003)

The medial change of *z to *r in environments such as **déuzaz* ‘deer’, **xúrdaz* ‘hoard’, and **líznojaną* ‘learn’ is historically a post-Proto-West-Germanic development. Ringe and Taylor argue that rhotacism was not inherited from Proto-Northwest Germanic and was not uniform within West Germanic (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 52, 98, 102). Crist separates this change explicitly from the deletion of word-final *z and argues that rhotacism must follow the deletion rules (Crist 2001, 104–6; 2002, 1, 4). Hogg gives the standard Old English-facing summary: *z yielded *r in intervocalic position but was generally lost in final position (Hogg 1992, 37).

The CAPR rule is named EAFRhotacism, placing it in the Early Anglo-Frisian corridor; CAPR’s operational post-Proto-West-Germanic stage on the English line; the reader-facing chapter label describes the change as a West Germanic rhotacism.

21.3.2 Word-final *z deletion (SC020) and the three final-*z developments

The loss of word-final *z is not one process but three historically distinct developments, and this chapter contains two of them. The central one, SC020, is the Proto-West Germanic loss of *z in unstressed syllables, seen in forms such as **rástōz* ‘rest (nom.sg.)’ and stated for the whole branch by Ringe and Taylor (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45); Crist’s analysis distinguishes it both from the earlier NWGmc changes and from the later narrower Ingvaemonic deletion rules (Crist

2002, 1, 4). Earlier still, the consonant-stem root nouns had generalized endingless nominatives before Proto-West Germanic (SC096, Chapter 2). Later, and only in the north, *z was lost in stressed monosyllables with compensatory lengthening (SC097, this chapter); the southern dialects instead retained and rhotacized it. The standard handbooks confirm the West Germanic deletion in general terms: Campbell notes that *z is “later lost or changed to r” (Campbell 1959); Hogg gives a clean statement that Germanic *z is generally lost in final position (Hogg 1992, 37); the three-way division refines those summaries rather than contradicting them.

The CAPR rule for the unstressed loss is still named `EAFFinalZDeletion`, an identifier that predates the restaging of the change to Proto-West Germanic; the name is retained as a stable identifier pending a global renaming pass, and the historical stage recorded in the staging metadata takes priority over the name prefix. SC020 remains presented in this chapter, beside rhotacism, because the two changes jointly determine the fate of every remaining *z.

21.3.3 Anglo-Frisian ai-monophthongization (SC004)

The monophthongization of stressed/root *ái to *ā, seen in the soul derivation, is a North Sea Germanic areal development. Versloot argues that it spread in successive waves through a dialect continuum, with Old English among the widest to carry it, so the change is better read as an areal diffusion through the continuum than as a single dated node (Versloot 2017, 281–324). The resulting *ā is later fronted to ē in the relevant Old English environments.

The CAPR rule is named `EAFaiMonophthongization` and executes at cascade position 28. That position is CAPR’s operational home for a North Sea Germanic areal change on the English line; it is a modelling choice, not a claim that the change passed through a discrete Proto-Anglo-Frisian node. The one usable chronological anchor is the soul derivation, which requires the monophthongization to precede OE interstress raising (SC036).

The unstressed development *ai > *ē (in final and nonfinal syllables) is a separate and earlier Proto-Northwest Germanic change (SC014), discussed in Chapter 2; its corpus witnesses are the dative-singular endings of *span* (**spánnai* ‘span’ > *spanne* ‘span’) and *meed* (**mízdai* ‘meed’ > *meorde* ‘meed’).

21.3.4 Anglo-Frisian brightening (SC043, treated in Chapter 4)

The fronting of low *a to *æ outside nasal environments is the defining Anglo-Frisian change. It executes later in the cascade than the changes of this chapter, so its full section appears in Chapter 4; it is introduced here because it anchors the “Anglo-Frisian” label that names this period. Campbell gives the classical statement: “By a very early change Prim. Gmc. a > æ in OE and OFris. when not followed by a nasal consonant” (Campbell 1959, sects 163–165). Hogg gives the most familiar modern label pair: “This vowel normally fronted to /æ/ by the sound change of Anglo-Frisian Brightening (or First Fronting)” (Hogg 1992, sect. 5.8).

The change is notable for what follows it: OE Breaking presupposes the fronted input; OE a-Restoration partially undoes it in back-vowel environments. The three-change sequence (brightening, breaking, restoration) is one of the clearest relative-chronology chains in the Old English historical grammar.

Campbell notes that English and Frisian may not simply reflect one undifferentiated shared pre-historic event, and Ringe and Taylor leave open whether the wider spread of fronted outcomes happened mainly on the continent or in Britain (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 60–62). CAPR’s implementation treats the change as a single rule; the book prose acknowledges the uncertainty about its exact geographical scope.

The current CAPR inventory has this change labeled “Old English” in the pipeline taxonomy (no separate Anglo-Frisian bucket previously existed). The historical staging map places its section in Chapter 4, at its executable cascade position.

21.4 Cascade vs. historical order in this chapter

The changes in this chapter are presented in the order in which they apply in the executable cascade, which models the reconstructed chronology itself: first word-final **z* deletion in unstressed syllables (SC020), then the later northern monosyllabic **z*-loss (SC097) that completes the final-**z* story, then West Germanic rhotacism (SC003), which turns every surviving **z* into **r* only after the deletions have run their course. There follow the unstressed **ō* raising (SC021), the **mn* dissimilation and *n*-stem **n* loss (SC022–SC023), the long-**ē* developments (SC024–SC025), the nasal-spirant corridor (SC026–SC027), and finally Anglo-Frisian ai-monophthongization (SC004, the North Sea areal vowel change) closing the chapter.

Book order, cascade order, and reconstructed historical order coincide here: in particular, the deletions of final **z* precede rhotacism both in the sources and in the executable derivation, so no form ever meets rhotacism with a word-final sibilant intact.

22 West Germanic final **z*-deletion

22.1 Historical discussion

Word-final **z* in unstressed syllables was lost in Proto-West Germanic. Ringe and Taylor state the change for the whole branch and illustrate it with the nominative plural **dagōz* > **dagō* and the consonant-stem nominative **fadurz* > **fadur*, noting that the ending is lost after consonants as well as after vowels (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). Crist’s handout formulates the same development and its Ingvaemonic sequels (Crist 2002, 2, §§5–6). The change is pan-West-Germanic, not specifically Ingvaemonic: every West Germanic daughter shows the loss, and the Friesland comb inscription *kaba* < **kambaz* ‘comb’ (c. 250–300 CE) supplies early epigraphic confirmation (Fulk 2018, 25, n. 1).

The conditioning segment is specifically the voiced sibilant **z*, never **s*: Ringe and Taylor’s near-minimal pair of nominative singular **dagaz* > **dag* beside genitive singular **dagas*, which keeps its sibilant into Old English *dægēs*, shows that the change reads the Verner voicing distinction (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 212, §6.1). Where the handbooks disagree about whether a given ending had **-s* or **-z* — as for the nominative plural **-ōz* — the disagreement matters directly to whether this rule applies (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 115–16, §4.2.1).

This is the middle of three historically distinct final-**z* developments, and Ringe and Taylor explicitly separate it from the later loss in stressed monosyllables, citing Crist’s demonstration that they are two changes (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). Earlier, the consonant-stem (root-noun) nominatives of monosyllables had already generalized endinglessness before Proto-West Germanic (SC096 RootNounNomZLoss), so forms like **bōkz* ‘book’ never reach this rule with their marker intact. Later, and only in the north, **z* was lost in stressed monosyllables with compensatory lengthening (SC097 MonosyllabicFinalZLoss); the present rule leaves stressed monosyllables untouched. Older accounts that grouped all of these under one loss of final **z*, such as Campbell’s, are superseded by this three-way division (Campbell 1959, 166).

At the boundary with Chapter 2’s Northwest Germanic sequence, the derivation of *ræste* ‘rest’ shows that final **ō*-raising (SC019 PNWGMcFinalLongORaising) must precede this rule: raising applies to **-ō* but not to **-ōz*, whose final vowel is still sheltered by the sibilant when raising runs (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 15–16, 24). On the later side, Ringe and Taylor order the loss of **z* before the loss of word-final bare **-a*, since **dagaz* first becomes **daga* and only then **dag* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 45–46, §3.1.2).

22.2 SC020. West Germanic final **z*-deletion (EAFFinalZDeletion)

```
define EAFFinalZDeletion [{*z} -> Ø ||
  .#. ?* EnglishStarVocalic
    [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]+
    EnglishStarVocalic ?* - .#. ,
  .#. [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]*
```

EnglishStarVocalic+ [EnglishStarConsonant EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ .#.] ;

The rule deletes word-final *z in unstressed syllables, stated through two environments. The first clause covers polysyllables, where the final syllable of these corpus forms is unstressed: this is the ordinary case, with 110 corpus derivations, such as PGmc **bárdaz* ‘beard’ on its way to OE *beard* ‘beard’ and **rástōz* ‘rest’ on its way to *ræste* ‘rest’. The second clause covers post-consonantal *z in monosyllables. By the time this rule runs, SC096 RootNounNomZLoss has already removed the genuine root-noun nominative endings, so the only form reaching the second clause is **frijōndz* ‘friend’, contracted to monosyllabic **friundz* by SC009 PWGmcIjContraction; its ending, like that of **fadurz*, stood in an unstressed syllable when the Proto-West Germanic change applied and so belongs here rather than to the root-noun development (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). Stressed monosyllables ending in vowel plus *z meet neither clause and are left for SC097 MonosyllabicFinalZLoss.

The chronology of word-final *z-loss is unusually well delimited: *ræste* ‘rest’ supplies its early boundary, while later weak syllables supply its late boundary.

Before SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising, PGmc **rástōz* ‘rest’ yields †*rast* rather than expected OE *ræste* ‘rest’. After SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering, PGmc **bébruz* ‘beaver’ yields †*befro* rather than expected *befer* ‘beaver’, PGmc **kwéðuz* ‘cud’ yields †*cwedo* rather than expected *cwedu* ‘cud’, and PGmc **félθuz* ‘field’ yields †*feldo* rather than expected *feld* ‘field’, alongside eight other newly failing rows. Final z-loss therefore follows SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising and precedes SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering.

The **rástōz* ‘rest’ derivation fixes the local relation to SC019 PNWGmcFinalLongORaising. The distant boundary at SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering shows only that word-final *z-loss precedes the later weak-syllable sequence; its placement within that wider interval follows the handbook chronology after final *ō-raising.

23 Early apocope in unstressed words

23.1 Historical discussion

Alongside the regular loss of word-final short high vowels in third syllables (SC006 PWGmcEarlyIApocope), Ringe and Taylor identify a second, earlier apocope: “Short high vowels were also lost after heavy syllables in unstressed words” (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 57–58, §3.1.4). The two laws must not be conflated. Fully stressed disyllables kept their final **i* long enough to cause i-umlaut — OE *giest* ‘guest’ < **gastiz* and *fȳr* ‘fire’ < **fūri* require exactly that survival (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 55, §3.1.4) — whereas words that carried no sentence stress lost the vowel already in Proto-West Germanic.

The conditioning is prosodic. Like Verner’s law, the change is governed by accent: it applied in words unstressed in the sentence, and its apparent exceptions are systematic, not sporadic. Forms such as OE *ymbe* ‘around’ and OHG *umbi* kept their final vowel because, as Ringe and Taylor observe, proclitics “were not phonologically word-final” and so stood outside the environment altogether (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 57–58, §3.1.4). Sentence-level accent placement therefore decides which sandhi variant each daughter language continues, and doublets across the family reflect the stressed and unstressed sentence forms of the same word — regular sandhi, not lexical diffusion.

The diagnostic witness is the second-person plural pronoun. Ringe and Taylor print the Proto-West Germanic form as a doublet: PGmc **izwiz* (Gothic *izwis*) → **iwwi* (by SC008 PWGmcCoronalWAssimilation and the loss of final **z*, SC020 EAffFinalZDeletion) → PWGmc **iuwi* ~ **iuw* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, §3.1.1). Old English continues the apocopated, unstressed variant, and Ringe and Taylor’s proof is the vocalism itself: “OE *iow* ‘you (dat. pl.)’ definitely does [show early apocope] (since it does not exhibit i-umlaut)” (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 57–58, §3.1.4). Had the **i* survived, i-umlaut (SC055 OEIUmlaut) would have fronted the diphthong; West Saxon *ēow* ‘you’ beside early West Saxon and Northumbrian *iow* ‘you’ shows the normal unumlauted development (Campbell 1959, sect. 702, p. 283).

23.2 SC098. Early apocope in unstressed words (PWGmcUnstressedWordFinalIApocope)

```
define PWGmcUnstressedWordFinalIApocope [  
  {*i} -> Ø || {*w} {*w} _ .#.   
];
```

The corpus transcription does not mark the absence of word stress, so the rule states the law through a proxy environment: word-final **i* after the geminate **ww* created by coronal-w assimilation, which in the present corpus is exactly coextensive with the law’s unstressed-word domain. The same convention serves SC096 RootNounNomZLoss, where a development whose true conditioning the notation cannot yet express is likewise implemented over an exactly coextensive segmental environment.

The corpus witness is ‘you’: **izwiz* → **iwwiz* (assimilation) → **iwwi* (final **z*-loss) → **iww* (this rule) → OE *ēow* ‘you’. The chronology is fixed on both sides. The rule is fed by the loss of final **z* (SC020 EAffFinalZDeletion), since only that loss makes the **i* word-final; and it must precede i-umlaut (SC055 OEIUmlaut) — that ordering is Ringe and Taylor’s own dating argument, for an unapocopated **iwwi* ‘you’ surviving to the umlaut period would yield an unumlauted diphthong and a form other than the attested *ēow* ‘you’. The rule applies within Proto-West Germanic, before the later northern loss of final **z* in stressed monosyllables (SC097 MonosyllabicFinalZLoss): Ringe and Taylor treat the apocope among the Proto-West Germanic final-syllable developments and print the apocopated variant as a Proto-West Germanic form (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, 57–58). Fully stressed disyllables are untouched, as the history requires: **gastiz* and **fūri* pass through unchanged and duly umlaut to *giest* ‘guest’ and *fȳr* ‘fire’.

The surviving word-final geminate **ww* is then vocalized to a long diphthong (SC033 OEEwLongDiphthong) before geminate simplification (SC031 OEWWsimplification) can destroy it — Ringe

and Taylor date that vocalization to Proto-West Germanic itself (**fewwar* → PWGmc **feubar*) (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42, §3.1.1; Fulk 2018, sect. 8.3, pp. 204–205) — giving **ēoww*, simplified to **ēow*, the attested Old English form.

24 Northern monosyllabic final *z-loss

24.1 Historical discussion

Long after the Proto-West Germanic loss of final *z in unstressed syllables (SC020 EAffFinalZDeletion), the northern West Germanic dialects lost word-final *z in stressed monosyllables as well, with compensatory lengthening of a short nucleus. Ringe and Taylor’s witness set is OE *mā* ‘more’ < **maiz*, the pronouns *wē* ‘we’, *gē* ‘you’, *mē* ‘me’, *bē* ‘thee’, *hē* ‘he’, *hwā* ‘who’ < **hwaz*, and — hedged in their own print with question marks — *cū* ‘cow’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86, §3.3.1). The southern dialects retained the sibilant and rhotacized it: Old High German *mīr*, *wīr*, *mēr*, *ēr* answer the Old English endingless forms, which is why Fulk counts this loss among the diagnostic Ingvaenonic features (Fulk 2018, 18, n. 6). Ringe and Taylor explicitly treat this as a change separate from the Proto-West Germanic unstressed loss, citing Crist’s demonstration that the two must be distinguished (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1).

The scholarship disagrees about the exact conditioning, and the disagreement is worth recording. An older account, represented by Campbell and going back to Luick, derived the endingless pronouns from unaccented sentence variants rather than from a regular sound change (Campbell 1959, 166; Luick 1914–1940, 819). Ringe and Taylor reject that analysis because *mā* ‘more’ and *cū* ‘cow’ are not plausibly unaccented words (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86, §3.3.1). Crist formulates an Ingvaenonic rule in which *z is lost after front vowels, with compensatory lengthening, covering preconsonantal cases as well; his data contain no word-final back-vowel monosyllables, so forms like **hwaz* and the ancestor of *cū* fall outside what his statement can decide — a documented gap rather than a refutation (Crist 2002, 1, 4, §§1, 10). Kilday narrows the preconsonantal subcase to Old Saxon and Old Frisian while accepting the word-final monosyllabic loss for Old English, contrasting regular *meord* ‘reward’ with the loanword-influenced *mēd* ‘reward’ (Kilday 2024, 1–3). CAPR adopts Ringe and Taylor’s quality-neutral formulation because it alone generates the back-vowel witnesses, while noting that the front-vowel forms are compatible with both analyses.

Apparent counterexamples are analogical, not phonological: OE *dēor* ‘deer’, *ār* ‘oar’, and *gār* ‘spear’ show final -r from levelling out of inflected forms where the sibilant was word-internal and regularly rhotacized, not from retention of word-final *z (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86, §3.3.1, n. 24). The change precedes rhotacism (SC003 EAFRhotacism), which Ringe and Taylor place last in this sequence of northern developments (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 87, §3.3.1).

The corpus now witnesses this change directly. The interrogative pronoun ‘who’ is selected in its nominative singular masculine cell, PGmc **hwaz* (Gothic *hwas*), precisely the form Ringe and Taylor cite for this loss (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86, §3.3.1): the rule lengthens the short nucleus and deletes the sibilant, giving **hwā*, whence OE *hwā* ‘who’. The resulting back vowel never undergoes Anglo-Frisian brightening — “**hwāe* does not exist”, as Campbell puts it (Campbell 1959, sect. 125, p. 49; Brunner 1965, sect. 137 Anm. 1, p. 129) — so the derivation ends with the attested form. Other members of Ringe and Taylor’s witness set remain outside the corpus because it selects oblique or plural cells for them — ‘cow’ and ‘meed’, for instance, enter the cascade in inflected forms whose *z, where present, is word-internal.

24.2 SC097. Northern monosyllabic final *z-loss (MonosyllabicFinalZLoss)

```
define MonosyllabicFinalZLoss [  
  {*a} -> {*ā}, {*á} -> {*ā},  
  {*e} -> {*ē}, {*é} -> {*ē},  
  {*i} -> {*ī}, {*í} -> {*ī},  
  {*o} -> {*ō}, {*ó} -> {*ō},  
  {*u} -> {*ū}, {*ú} -> {*ū}  
  || .#. [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]*  
  _ {*z} .#. ]  
] .o. [  
  {*z} -> 0 ||  
  .#. [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]*
```

The rule first lengthens a short nucleus standing immediately before word-final *z in a monosyllable, then deletes the *z after any vowel in a monosyllable. The principal synthetic controls run the change on Ringe and Taylor’s own witnesses, fed to the rule in their chronologically correct intermediate shapes. Short-nucleus inputs show both halves of the change at once: *hwaz yields *hwā and *hiz yields *hī, each with loss of the sibilant and compensatory lengthening (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86, §3.3.1). A form whose nucleus is already bimoric skips the lengthening step and simply loses the sibilant: *maiz yields *mai at this stage, with its diphthong intact; the attested OE *mā* ‘more’ arises only later, when the stressed monophthongization (SC004 EAFaiMonophthongization) takes *ai to *ā. The word ‘cow’, whose history Ringe and Taylor themselves print with question marks and whose analysis remains disputed, is deliberately not used as a principal control; a long-vowel input of that shape (*kūz yielding *kū) merely repeats what *maiz already demonstrates, and the word’s evidentiary weight is discussed in the historical dossier rather than leaned on here.

The corpus derivation of *hwā* ‘who’ now fixes this rule’s position empirically as well as philologically. It stands after SC020 EAffFinalZDeletion, since the two losses are historically distinct changes with the unstressed loss earlier (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45, §3.1.1). Rhotacism (SC003 EAFRhotacism) follows in the executable cascade as in the historical account: Ringe and Taylor place rhotacism after this loss, at the end of the sequence of *z-losses (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 87, §3.3.1), and the cascade composes it immediately after this rule, so a sibilant removed here can never surface as -r — were the order reversed, *hwaz would rhotacize to *hwar and ‘who’ could never be derived; the negative controls below confirm this. Consonant-final monosyllables are untouched: their nominative *-z, where it ever existed, was eliminated before Proto-West Germanic under SC096 RootNounNomZLoss. Word-internal *z, as in PGmc *déuzq ‘deer’ on its way to OE *dēor* ‘deer’, does not meet the environment of this rule and duly rhotacizes.

25 West Germanic rhotacism

25.1 Historical discussion

Hogg states that Germanic **z* yielded **r* in intervocalic position in Old English, while final **z* was generally lost (Hogg 1992, 37). Ringe and Taylor argue that this merger of **z* with **r* was independent in Norse and West Germanic and belongs after the Proto-West-Germanic stage (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 52, 98, 102). Crist likewise places rhotacism after earlier West Germanic **z*-deletion rules and rejects treating it as an inherited Proto-Northwest-Germanic innovation (Crist 2001, 104–6; 2002, 1, 4).

The internal identifier SC003 EAFRhotacism places the change in CAPR’s Early Anglo-Frisian corridor, the operational post-Proto-West-Germanic stage on the English line; historically the change is a West Germanic rhotacism, later than Proto-Germanic. It is also distinct from SC020 EAffFinalZDeletion, which removes final **z* before the surviving medial consonant becomes **r*.

25.2 SC003. West Germanic rhotacism (EAFRhotacism)

```
define EAFRhotacism [  
  {*z} -> {*r} || EnglishStarVocalic _ ?  
];
```

Breaking supplies the decisive upper boundary. If rhotacism is delayed until after SC044 OEBreaking, PGmc **líznojaną* ‘learn’ yields [†]*lirnian* rather than expected OE *liornian* ‘learn’, PGmc **líznoθi* ‘learns’ yields [†]*lirnaþ* rather than expected *liornaþ* ‘learns’, PGmc **lízno* ‘learn’ yields [†]*lirna* rather than expected *liorna* ‘learn’, and PGmc **mízdai* ‘meed’ yields [†]*merde* rather than expected OE *meorde* ‘meed’. Moving rhotacism earlier within the tested range changes no output.

The lexical evidence thus supplies a terminus ante quem but no terminus post quem. The lower boundary rests on the historical analyses cited above: Ringe and Taylor put rhotacism at the end of the sequence of **z*-losses — “first **z* was lost in a variety of environments ..., then all surviving **z* became **r*” (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 87, §3.3.1) — and Crist observes that the deletions distinguish **z* from **r* and so must precede the merger (Crist 2002, 2–3). The rule is accordingly ordered after the three final-**z* losses (SC096 RootNounNomZLoss, SC020 EAffFinalZDeletion, and SC097 MonosyllabicFinalZLoss) and before breaking, so that the derivation follows the reconstructed chronology.

26 *mn*-dissimilation

26.1 Historical discussion

In the inherited *n*-stem paradigm the zero-grade oblique cells brought *m* and *n* into direct contact, and in that adjacent cluster the labial nasal dissimilated to a labial spirant: *mn* > *βn* (surfacing as *fn*). Old Norse preserves the older paradigmatic distribution, with the labial confined to the oblique cluster (*himinn* ‘heaven’ beside dative *hifni*); Old English and Old Saxon generalized it. Fulk treats the cluster change among developments common to Germanic, while warning that its surface results are irregular and that reverse *bn* > *mn* is later well attested in Northwest Germanic (Fulk 2018, 121, §6.11). The relevant *heofon* ‘heaven’ and *mōnaþ* ‘month’ material is discussed by Campbell (Campbell 1959, 189, 195, §§470, 484).

The underlying cluster change is therefore late Proto-Germanic / Common Germanic, not securely a pan-Northwest-Germanic innovation; PNWGmc remains a stable executable identifier only. The lexical evidence does not constrain a positive local cascade position.

26.2 SC022. Dissimilation of adjacent *mn* (PNWGmcMnDissimilation)

```
define PNWGmcMnDissimilation [  
  {*m} -> {*β}  
  || EnglishStarVocalic _ {*n}  
];
```

The rule fires only where *m* stands directly before *n*. It supplies the labial of *stefn* ‘stem, trunk’ from the *mn*-cluster of the *stamn*-family, and it is the historical change behind the labial of *heofon* ‘heaven’, which was generalized from the oblique cluster into the vowel-bearing stem before the Old English vocalic changes. (An earlier cross-syllable formulation that labialized an intervocalic *m* before a later nasal has been retired: it simulated paradigm levelling rather than a sound law.)

Moving SC022 PNWGmcMnDissimilation earlier or later leaves every output unchanged. Its executable place in this holding zone is therefore editorial/computational, while its historical classification rests on the handbook account of *mn*-dissimilation.

27 Word-final *n*-loss

27.1 Historical discussion

The change isolated here is far older than its position in the cascade suggests: it is the general (pre-)Proto-Germanic loss of word-final **n*, with nasalization of the preceding vowel, in polysyllables. Ringe’s proof set for the law spans the whole grammar — nouns such as **yugón* > **juką* ‘yoke’, pronouns such as **tón* > **panō*, and even the verb form **dedō* ‘I did’ — so it is general phonology, not a fact about any one declension (Ringe 2017, 101–3). Gothic *tuggo* shares the weak nominative-singular outcome, and the nasalized reflex **-ō̃* remained contrastive into Proto-West Germanic before yielding OE *-e* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 54–55, 58–59).

Within the present corpus the change surfaces in exactly one shape: the weak nouns are cited in the stem form **-ōn-*, and this rule carries them to the Proto-Germanic nominative singular in **-ō̃*, as in **túngōn* > **túngō̃* > *tunge* ‘tongue’, alongside *eorpe* ‘earth’, *heorte* ‘heart’, *nædre* ‘adder’, and thirteen further weak nouns. The masculine weak nominative singular in trimoric **-ō* never had a final **-n* to lose, and Proto-Germanic **sebun* ‘seven’, **nigun* ‘nine’, and **tehun* ‘ten’ kept their *-n* by lexical analogy among the numerals (Ringe 2017, 103); the rule’s narrow **-ōn* environment leaves all of these correctly untouched.

27.2 SC023. Loss of word-final **n* after **ō* (PNWGmcNStemNLoss)

```
define PNWGmcNStemNLoss [  
    {*ō} {*n} -> {*ō̃} || _ .#.  
];
```

The verb *dōn* ‘do’ supplies the negative, counterfeeding witness for the chronology. PGmc **dōnq* ‘do’ passes this rule untouched; only SC047 OEHeavySyllableNasalApocope later strips the final **q* and creates a new word-final **-ōn*. That secondary **-n* survives into *dōn* precisely because the old loss was no longer active: if SC023 PNWGmcNStemNLoss is displaced after the apocope, it consumes the new nasal and the derivation collapses entirely (+?).

The retained *-n* of *dōn* ‘do’ therefore supplies a terminus ante quem for the loss — it must be dead before the apocope — while the seventeen weak nouns above are its positive witnesses; the lower boundary remains unattested within the cascade, as befits a change already complete in Proto-Germanic.

28 Nasal spirant changes

28.1 Historical discussion

Germanic lost nasal consonants before voiceless fricatives twice, in two changes that are easily confused because their outcomes look alike. Both replace a sequence of vowel, nasal and fricative with a long nasalized vowel and the fricative. They differ in date, in geography, and in which fricatives they affect.

The earlier change is common Germanic and is treated in the opening chapter of this book, on the Proto-Germanic loss of a nasal before **x*. Its results are shared by every daughter language, and only **a*, **i* and **u* occur in its input (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1; Ringe 2017, 149–50, §3.2.7).

The later change belongs to the dialects bordering the North Sea, that is to Old English, Old Frisian and Old Saxon, the group traditionally called Ingvaemonic. Here the groups **mf*, **ns* and **np* likewise reject the nasal with compensatory lengthening and nasalization (Campbell 1959, 47, §121; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11; Brunner 1965, 176, §186.1; Luick 1914–1940, 276, §301.1). Ringe and Taylor call it the most obvious phonological innovation of the northern dialects and list some thirty examples, among them **gans* ‘goose’ and **jugunþi* ‘youth’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 139–41). Campbell describes it as a later change similar to the common Germanic one, and Fulk as comparable to it; neither treats them as the same law.

The two are told apart by what the languages outside the North Sea area show. The common Germanic change left no nasal anywhere, so Old High German has *fūht* ‘damp’ and *fūst* ‘fist’ exactly as Old English does. The later change was confined to the north, so the cognates of its witnesses keep the nasal: Old High German *fimf*, *gans*, *ander*, *jugund* answer Old English *fif* ‘five’, *gōs* ‘goose’, *ōþer* ‘other’, *ġeoguh* ‘youth’. On this test **funhsti-* ‘fist’, whose long vowel is shared by Old High German *fūst*, Dutch *vuist* and German *Faust*, belongs to the earlier change and not to the North Sea law at all (Kroonen 2013, 160).

Where the vowel was **a*, the long nasalized vowel that this law produced was afterwards rounded to *ō* in Anglo-Frisian, which is why Old English has *gōs*, *tōþ* ‘tooth’ and *ōþer* ‘other’. That rounding is a third change again, and it is the same rounding that gives *fōn* ‘seize’ and *þōhte* ‘thought’ from the common Germanic law and *mōna* ‘moon’ and *spōn* ‘chip’ from inherited long *ā* before a surviving nasal; Campbell states that it reached all three sources at one and the same time (Campbell 1959, 50, §128 n. 1; Brunner 1965, 33, §26; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11). It is treated in the chapter on the rounding of the long nasalized low vowel. That the vowel was rounded and did not simply merge shows that its nasality survived the law that created it: as Fulk observes, it did not fall together with the *ā* that came from **ai* (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1). Ringe and Taylor take the nasalization to have remained subphonemic until it was lost separately in each daughter (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 141). Old Saxon shares the loss of the nasal and the nasalization, and rounds only variably, which is why the law itself is described as North Sea Germanic and the rounding as Anglo-Frisian (Campbell 1959, 47, §121; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11).

The North Sea Germanic law is a single connected sound change: in every handbook account the nasal is lost *with* compensatory lengthening, and the lengthening is the compensation for the loss. It is stated here as two rules only because the vowel must be adjusted while the conditioning nasal is still present, before the nasal can be removed. The order of SC026 EAFNasalSpirantLengthening before SC027 EAFNasalSpirantLoss is a requirement of the statement, not evidence for two successive historical stages.

28.2 SC026. North Sea Germanic nasal-spirant law, first step (EAFNasalSpirantLengthening)

```
define EAFNasalSpirantLengthening [  
  {*a} -> {*ā} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant,  
  {*i} -> {*ī} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant,  
  {*u} -> {*ū} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant,  
  {*á} -> {*ā} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant,
```

```

    {*ī} -> {*i} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant,
    {*ū} -> {*u} || _ EnglishStarNasal EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant
];

```

The environment is nasal plus **f*, **þ* or **s*. The fricative **x* is excluded: nasal loss before **x* is the earlier change stated as SC103 PGmcNasalLossBeforeX. Campbell names the groups **mf*, **ns* and **nþ*, Fulk says the change affects **mf*, **ns* and **nþ*, Sievers and Brunner name the fricatives **f*, **þ* and **s*, and no example in Ringe and Taylor’s list contains **x* (Campbell 1959, 47, §121; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11; Brunner 1965, 176, §186.1; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 139–41). As in the earlier change, only **a*, **i* and **u* occur. The outcome of **a* is the long nasalized **ā*, which SC104 EAFNasalized-LowRounding later rounds; the outcomes of **i* and **u* are written **ī* and **ū*, their nasality having no further consequence (Campbell 1959, 47, §121).

Two witnesses apply in the present corpus. PGmc **gánsz* ‘goose’ becomes **gāns*, and PGmc **júgunθ* ‘youth’ becomes **júgūnθ*. In *geogub* the syllable carrying the lengthened vowel is unstressed, and the length is given up again by the later shortening of unstressed syllables; Sievers and Brunner note the same course in *beraþ* ‘they carry’ from **beranþi* through **berōþ* (Brunner 1965, 176, §186.1 Anm. 3; Luick 1914–1940, 276, §301.1).

If the rule is stated after the loss of the nasal, PGmc **gánsz* yields *†geas* in place of *gōs*, and PGmc **júgunθ* yields *†geogop* in place of *geogub*. This shows only that the vowel must be adjusted before its conditioning nasal is removed. It does not establish a date for either operation, and no earlier or later boundary is claimed here.

28.3 SC027. North Sea Germanic nasal-spirant law, second step (EAFNasalSpirantLoss)

```

define EAFNasalSpirantLoss [
    EnglishStarNasal -> 0 || _ EnglishStarNSGmcSpirant
];

```

The nasal is removed in the environment that conditioned the lengthening, giving **gās* and **júgūθ*. The rule completes the statement of the single change begun in SC026 EAFNasalSpirantLengthening; the two are not independent sound laws. The converse test, stating the loss first, merely reproduces the same two wrong forms. Nothing in the material fixes a later boundary for the loss.

29 Hiatus-filling *w* in the *verba pura*

29.1 Historical discussion

The small class of Germanic strong verbs whose roots ended in a vowel — the *verba pura* — reached Northwest Germanic with a morphologically expected hiatus. Ringe and Taylor reconstruct Proto-Germanic **sēanq* ‘to sow’ (Gothic *saian*), which the Northwest Germanic lowering of **ē₁* carried to **sāanq*; the West Germanic languages then “exhibit innovative consonants that eliminated” the hiatus (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 12). The repair differs by branch, and the difference dates and localizes the change: Old English and Old Frisian inserted *w* — Old English *sāwan* ‘to sow’, Old Frisian *sāwinge* beside *grōwinge* ‘growth’ — while Old Saxon and Old High German used *j* instead (*sāian*, *sāen*, *sājen*) (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 12, 151). The insertion of *w* is therefore an Anglo-Frisian development, not a common West Germanic one, and the consonant of *sāwan* is not inherited: it must not be projected back into the protoform.

Ringe and Taylor locate the origin of the glide precisely: it arose first between the stem vowel and the **u*-initial endings — present indicative first singular **-u*, past indicative plural **-un* — and was generalized from there through the rest of the paradigm (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 151). The rule below models the outcome of that generalization on citation forms; the layering of regular insertion and analogical spread belongs to the historical record rather than to the executable statement.

The chronology is fixed on both sides by Ringe and Taylor. The insertion must postdate the West Germanic loss of intervocalic **w*, or the new glide would itself have been swept away (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 151, n. 9); and it “must have occurred early enough to prevent fronting of **ā*” in pre-Old English (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 151) — the whole reason *sāwan*, *cnāwan* ‘to know’, *blāwan* ‘to blow’, and *māwan* ‘to mow’ keep their back vowel is that the *w* was already in place when the North Sea Germanic fronting applied. The insertion accordingly stands before the fronting in the cascade, even though, on the present corpus, the two orders happen to produce the same outputs: the fronting rule as implemented does not touch a prevocalic *ā* in any case, so the ordering encodes the historical chronology rather than a corpus-internal contrast.

29.2 SC102. Hiatus-filling *w* after long *ā* (EAFHiatusWInsertion)

```
define EAFHiatusWInsertion [  
  [...] -> {*w} || {*ā} _ EnglishStarVocalic  
];
```

The rule is fed by SC024 PNWGmcLongELowering, which creates the *ā*-initial hiatus it repairs: **séanq* ‘to sow’ passes through **sāanq* to **sāwanq* on its way to *sāwan*. Displaced before the lowering, the rule can never apply — the root vowel is still **ē* and no hiatus after *ā* exists — and the derivation loses its consonant altogether.

Its output in turn feeds the blocking environment of SC101 EAFLongAFronting: the inserted *w* is precisely what shields the *ā* of *sāwan* from fronting, as treated in that chapter. The corpus carries *sāwan* as the diagnostic witness of the class; *cnāwan*, *blāwan*, *māwan*, *wāwan*, and *prāwan* instantiate the same derivation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 151).

30 North Sea Germanic nasalization of long $\bar{a}$ before a nasal

30.1 Historical discussion

In the dialects along the North Sea coast the long low vowel $*\bar{a}$ — centrally the vowel produced from $*\bar{e}_1$ by the Northwest Germanic lowering — was nasalized when a nasal consonant followed and survived. The nasalized vowel was afterwards rounded in Anglo-Frisian, which is why Old English has *mōna* ‘moon’, *mōnaþ* ‘month’ and *spōn* ‘spoon’ against Old High German *māno*, *mānōd*, *spān* and Old Norse *máni*, *mánaðr*, *spánn*. Campbell describes the split of Germanic $\bar{e}^1$ before nasals in these terms and identifies the vowel that the rounding operated on as a nasalized and unrounded $*\bar{q}$ [Campbell (1959), p. 50, §127; p. 50, §128 n. 1]. Fulk places the rounded outcome of $*\bar{e}$ before nasals among the Anglo-Frisian changes and derives it from an earlier nasalized vowel (Fulk 2018, 72–73, §4.12).

The nasalization and the rounding have different geographies, and separating them resolves an apparent disagreement in the handbooks. Ringe and Taylor state that stressed low vowels were nasalized in the northern West Germanic dialects, Old Saxon among them (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142, §5.1.2); Old Saxon accordingly shows *ōdar* ‘other’ and *sōd* ‘true’ beside unrounded *quān* ‘wife’ and *sāno* ‘immediately’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 150–51). What Old Saxon shares is the nasalization; what it shares only in part is the rounding, and for the vowel inherited from Proto-Germanic it does not share the rounding at all (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11). The nasalization stated here is therefore North Sea Germanic, and the rounding treated in the chapter on the long nasalized low vowel is Anglo-Frisian.

The nasalization is the conditioned counterpart of the fronting of oral $*\bar{a}$ treated in the fronting chapter: a following nasal gives nasalization and eventual rounding, and its absence gives fronting. Together the two exhaust the fate of the old low vowel in this area. The comparative material does not order the two branches against each other, and no such ordering is claimed here.

30.2 SC025. Nasalization of long $\bar{a}$ before nasals (EAFLongANasalRounding)

```
define EAFLongANasalRounding [  
  {*\bar{a}} -> {*\bar{q}} || _ EnglishStarNasal  
];
```

The rule consumes the $*\bar{a}$ created by SC024 PNWGmcLongELowering: displacing the lowering after this rule leaves the nasalization without an input, and $*m\acute{e}n\acute{o}\theta z$ ‘month’ surfaces as $^{\dagger}m\bar{a}n\acute{a}\theta$ in place of OE *mōnaþ*, $*sp\acute{e}nuz$ ‘spoon’ as $^{\dagger}sp\bar{a}n$ in place of *spōn*. Its output is consumed in turn by SC104 EAFNasalizedLowRounding, which supplies the rounded vowel that the two words actually show.

Equally important is what the rule must precede. The monophthongization of $*ai$ in SC004 EAFai-Monophthongization creates a new long $\bar{a}$, and that vowel was never nasalized and never rounded before nasals: *stān* ‘stone’ and *hām* ‘home’ keep $\bar{a}$. Stating the monophthongization before this rule makes the new vowel eligible for nasalization and hence for rounding, and the cascade then wrongly yields $^{\dagger}st\bar{o}n$ and $^{\dagger}h\bar{o}m$. This is the same chronological inference Campbell draws for the fronting: the treatments of the old low vowel were complete, or at least under way, before *ai*-monophthongization supplied a new one (Campbell 1959, 52–53, §132; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 169–70).

31 Anglo-Frisian rounding of the long nasalized low vowel

31.1 Historical discussion

Three separate developments described in earlier chapters end in the same sound: a long, nasalized, low vowel. The oldest is the Proto-Germanic loss of a nasal before **x*; the second is the North Sea Germanic nasal-spirant law; the third is the nasalization of the inherited long *ā* before a nasal that survived. In Old English and Old Frisian all three surface as *ō*, and Campbell states the unification without qualification: the nasalized vowel became identical with the *ō* inherited from Proto-Germanic already in prehistoric Old English, and the same change affected the nasalized vowel of the Proto-Germanic law and the nasalized vowel of the Ingvaeonic law at one and the same time (Campbell 1959, 50, §128 n. 1). One later sound change therefore accounts for all three, and the appearance of three independent roads to *ō* is an illusion created by looking only at the Old English surface.

That the intermediate vowel was nasalized and unrounded is shown by a form in which it was shortened very early. Campbell's example is *samcucu* 'half alive', where the shortened reflex is *a* and never *o*; the vowel that the earlier laws produced was therefore a nasalized **ā̃*, and the rounding is a distinct and later event (Campbell 1959, 50, §128 n. 1). Sievers and Brunner describe the same nasalized long vowel and its rounded Old English outcome [Brunner (1965), p. 33, §26; p. 58, §64].

The geography is Anglo-Frisian. Old Saxon nasalized its stressed low vowels along with the rest of the northern West Germanic area (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142, §5.1.2), and it shares the loss of the nasal in both of the earlier laws; the categorical, systematic rounding, however, it does not share. For the Proto-Germanic nasalized low vowel Old Saxon retains *ā* consistently, and for the vowel created by the nasal-spirant law it has *ā* or *ō* according to word and dialect, while Old English and Old Frisian have *ō* throughout (Campbell 1959, 44, §119; Fulk 2018, 72, §4.11). That partial and lexically variable Old Saxon rounding is comparative evidence bearing on the innovation rather than participation in it. Ringe treats the rounding as a parallel development of the diverging northern dialects and locates it in the northernmost of them, that is in Anglo-Frisian (Ringe 2017, 149–50, §3.2.7; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142, §5.1.2). Luick groups the whole set of changes among those peculiar to the Anglo-Frisian dialect group and notes that the nasalized vowel later gave up its nasality (Luick 1914–1940, 276, §301.1). The rounding is accordingly Anglo-Frisian, and the nasalization that feeds it is the wider North Sea Germanic property.

Ringe and Taylor confirm that a single rounding covers all the sources: the rounding affected the nasalized low vowels of the nasal-spirant law, the nasalized low vowels of the accompanying list, and the reflexes of Proto-Germanic **/anh/* alike (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142, §5.1.2). The condition on the input is nasality and nothing else, which is why the long *ā* that Old English later won from **ai* escapes: that vowel was oral, and it came into being after the rounding had run its course. Fulk makes this the central argument for the long survival of the nasality, since the nasalized vowel developed to *ō* and did not fall together with Old English *ā* from **ai* (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1).

31.2 SC104. Rounding of the long nasalized low vowel (EAFNasalizedLowRounding)

```
define EAFNasalizedLowRounding [  
  {*ā̃} -> {*ō}  
];
```

The rule is unconditioned, since the vowel it operates on exists only where one of the three earlier changes created it. Its inputs arrive from SC103 PGmcNasalLossBeforeX, from SC026 EAFNasalSpirantLengthening and from SC025 EAFLongANasalRounding, and each of those three stands in a feeding relation to it: stated before any one of them, the rule leaves that source's nasalized vowel untouched and the cascade returns no form at all for its witnesses.

Four lexemes in the present corpus reach Old English through this rule, and between them

they witness all three sources. **gánsz* ‘goose’ arrives as **gā̃s* from the North Sea Germanic law and gives *gōs*; **ménōθz* ‘month’ arrives as **mā̃nōþ* and gives *mōnaþ*; **spénuz* ‘spoon’ arrives as **spā̃nu* and gives *spōn*. The Proto-Germanic law contributes **θánxtē*, the preterite of the verb ‘to think’, which arrives as **θā̃xtē* and gives *pōhte* ‘thought’. That is the very form cited for this rounding, beside Old Frisian *thochte*, and it is the evidence that the vowel did not fall together with the *ā* of *stān* (Fulk 2018, 55, §4.1; Campbell 1959, 44, §119). The other firing of the Proto-Germanic law, the high vowel of *fȳst* ‘fist’, does not reach this rule at all.

The counterpart is what the rule leaves alone. **stáinaz* ‘stone’ and **xáimaz* ‘home’ acquire their long *ā* from SC004 EAFAiMonophthongization, which follows this rule, and their vowel was never nasalized; they surface as *stān* and *hām*. Placing the monophthongization before the nasalization and the rounding makes that vowel eligible and the cascade then yields *†stōn* and *†hōm*, which is the chronological inference Campbell draws for the treatments of the old low vowel generally (Campbell 1959, 52–53, §132; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 169–70).

32 North Sea Germanic fronting of long $\bar{a}$

32.1 Historical discussion

Long after the Northwest Germanic lowering of $*\bar{e}_1$ to $*\bar{a}$, the dialects of the North Sea coast fronted the surviving oral $*\bar{a}$ to a low front vowel: West Saxon $\bar{a}$ in *dēd* ‘deed’, *slēpan* ‘to sleep’, *lētan* ‘to let’, *rēdan* ‘to read’, and *mēl* ‘meal’, against Anglian, Kentish, and Old Frisian $\bar{e}$ (*dēd*, *slēpa*, *jēr*) (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 146–50; Campbell 1959, 50–51, §128). Old Saxon and Old High German keep the back vowel (Old Saxon *dād*, Old High German *tāt*, *slāfan*, *lāzan*), but sporadic Old Saxon spellings in $\bar{a}$ show that the fronting lapped unevenly into Old Saxon territory (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 150). The change is therefore a North Sea Germanic development rather than an exclusively Anglo-Frisian one, though only Old English and Old Frisian carry it through systematically.

The fronting affected stressed, non-nasalized $*\bar{a}$; nasalized $*\bar{q}$ was instead rounded, as treated in the rounding chapter. Ringe and Taylor further establish a conditioning by a following $*w$. Before $*w$ plus a back or non-high vowel the $*\bar{a}$ was retained: the clearest witnesses are the *verba pura* — *sāwan* ‘to sow’, *cnāwan* ‘to know’, *blāwan* ‘to blow’, *māwan* ‘to mow’, *brāwan* ‘to turn’ — together with *clāwu* ‘claw’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 151); the simplest hypothesis, which Ringe and Taylor adopt from Hogg, is that fronting never occurred in that environment (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 151; Hogg 1992, 81). Before $*w$ plus a high front vocalic, by contrast, the fronting did apply: **lēwijanq* ‘to betray’ (Gothic *lēwjan*, Old High German *gilāen*) yields West Saxon *lēwan*, and the same environment appears in *eltāwe* ‘entire’ and *brāw* ‘eyelid’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 150). Both sides of the condition are encoded in the rule below and witnessed in the corpus. Bennett states the retaining environment independently from the West Saxon evidence alone, and slightly more broadly: West Saxon “shows $\bar{a}$ as a regular isolative development of IE $\bar{e}$ but has $\bar{a}$ before w or g plus a back vowel”, with the paradigmatic alternation *wæg* ‘wave’ beside plural *wāgas* (Bennett 1950, 235, n. 6). The rule below encodes the w environment, for which the corpus supplies witnesses on both sides; the parallel g environment is left for separate treatment.

Whether this fronting restored a front vowel that had earlier been backed, or whether — as Fulk argues — the North Sea dialects simply retained an old front $*\bar{a}$ that was never backed at all, is the same dispute recorded in the lowering chapter (Fulk 2018, 60–61, §4.6; Campbell 1959, 50–51, §§128–129). On the retention analysis this chapter’s change dissolves into the non-event of staying put; the present model follows Ringe and Taylor’s two-step reconstruction, on the strength of the runic evidence for an early [a:] and the place-adverbs *pær* ‘there’ and *hwær* ‘where’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 13–14).

32.2 SC101. Fronting of long $\bar{a}$ outside nasal and w environments (EAFLongAFronting)

```
define EAFLongAFronting [  
  { $\bar{a}$ } -> { $\bar{æ}$ } || _ [EnglishStarConsonant - EnglishStarNasal - { $*w$ }],  
  { $\bar{a}$ } -> { $\bar{æ}$ } || _ { $*w$ } EnglishIUmlautTrigger  
];
```

The first clause fronts $*\bar{a}$ before any oral consonant other than $*w$; the second admits the fronting before $*w$ exactly when a high front vocalic follows. The two corpus witnesses of the w condition form a minimal contrast. **séanq* ‘to sow’, whose hiatus-filling w is supplied by SC102 EAF-HiatusWInsertion, reaches this rule as **sāwanq* and is left unfronted, surfacing as *sāwan*; were the w -block removed, the cascade would deliver $^{\dagger}sāwan$ instead. **lēwijanq* ‘to betray’, whose inherited w is followed by $*i$, is fronted by the second clause to **lēwijanq* at this rule’s own stage — before, and independently of, the much later i -umlaut — and surfaces as *lēwan*. The rule consumes the $*\bar{a}$ created by SC024 PNWGmcLongELowering; displaced before the lowering, it has nothing to front, and **skēpq* ‘sheep’ surfaces as $^{\dagger}scāp$ rather than OE *scēap*, **jérq* ‘year’ as $^{\dagger}gār$ rather than *gēar*, **slēpanq* ‘to sleep’ as $^{\dagger}slāpan$ rather than *slēpan*.

Two later boundaries carry real historical content. First, the fronting must precede the completion of SC004 EAFaiMonophthongization: the $\bar{a}$ that arose from $*ai$ was never fronted — *stān*

‘stone’, *hām* ‘home’, *lāþ* ‘hostile’, *rāþ* ‘rope’, *tācn* ‘token’, *gāst* ‘spirit’ all keep the back vowel. Campbell draws exactly this chronological inference (Campbell 1959, 52–53, §132), and Ringe and Taylor endorse it as cogent (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 169–70); in the present cascade the inference is enforced by rule order, and displacing the fronting after the monophthongization wrongly yields [†]*lāþ*, [†]*rāþ*, [†]*tācn*, [†]*sāwol*, and [†]*gēast*. Historically the two changes may well have overlapped in time; the discrete ordering is the grammar’s way of stating that inherited *ā* had been fronted before the new *ā* arose.

Second, the fronting must precede SC056 OEWSPalatalDiphthongization, which operated on the already-fronted vowel: *ǣ* > *ēa* after the palatals, as in *scēap* ‘sheep’ and *gēar* ‘year’ (Campbell 1959, 69–70, §185; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–16, §6.5.1). Displaced after the diphthongization, the cascade yields [†]*scāþ* and [†]*gāer* instead.

33 Anglo-Frisian ai-monophthongization

33.1 Historical discussion

Inherited stressed **ái* monophthongized to **ā* across the North Sea Germanic area. Ringe and Taylor place the monophthongization of **ai* among the widespread early vowel developments of the English line (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 40–41). Versloot shows that the stressed development spread in successive waves through a dialect continuum, with Old English among the widest to carry it (Versloot 2017, 281–324). The Old English **ā* is later fronted to *æ* in the relevant environments.

The change is areal in character. It is shared with Frisian, and its spread through the continuum gives it a range of dates and no single sharp moment.

All twenty-four corpus witnesses carry stressed **ái*; loam **láimq* ‘loam’ is one of them, stressed in its Old English protoform. The unstressed development **ai* > **ē* is the separate earlier change SC014 PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization.

33.2 SC004. Anglo-Frisian ai-monophthongization (EAFaiMonophthongization)

```
define EAFaiMonophthongization [  
  {*ái} -> {*ā}  
];
```

The soul form fixes the relation to interstress raising. If the monophthongization is delayed until after that change, PGmc **sáiwalo* ‘soul’ yields *†sāwel* rather than expected OE *sāwol* ‘soul’. An earlier placement changes no output. This shows that SC004 EAFaiMonophthongization must come before SC036 OEInterStressRaising in the modeled sequence.

The unstressed development **ai* > **ē* in final and nonfinal syllables is a separate and earlier change; see SC014 PNWGmcUnstressedAiMonophthongization.

34 Chapter 4. From Anglo-Frisian to Old English

34.1 Historical interval

This chapter covers the sound changes that occurred within the Old English period: the changes that produced attested Old English from the prehistoric English forms that emerged from the Anglo-Frisian stage. The starting point is the end of the Anglo-Frisian changes of Chapter 3; the ending point is attested West Saxon Old English, the primary dialect of the CAPR corpus.

34.2 Scope and dialect variation

Not every change in this chapter has pan-Old-English scope. Some changes — most notably West Saxon palatal umlaut (SC060), the back-mutation rules (SC059), and the West Saxon diphthong chain (SC031–SC034) — are specifically West Saxon or more broadly southern Old English phenomena. (The West Saxon palatal-glide spellings, SC016, belong to the written surface of Old English and are treated in Chapter 5.)

The CAPR derivations target West Saxon Old English citation forms as the default comparator. Changes that belong to other dialects, or that are absent from West Saxon, may appear in lexical entries as comparanda rather than as derivational steps.

The existing reader-facing sound-change sections record which changes have pan-Old-English scope and which are specifically West Saxon or Anglian (Campbell 1959, sects 1–10; Hogg 1992, sects 1.1–1.15).

34.3 Chapter structure

The changes in this chapter fall into several natural historical subgroups, though the boundaries between them are not always sharp:

Early Old English changes linked to the Anglo-Frisian inheritance: Changes that feed directly on, or are closely related to, Anglo-Frisian brightening (SC043), whose section opens the vowel corridor of this chapter. The *awj glide formation (SC029), *au fronting (SC030), and the West Saxon diphthong chain (SC031–SC034) all operate on the vowel inventory shaped by Anglo-Frisian brightening. OE Breaking (SC044) and a-Restoration (SC046) similarly presuppose the fronted *æ input.

Old English consonantal changes: Velar palatalization (SC052), palatalization of *sk (SC051), j-cluster coalescence (SC057), and related changes produce the characteristically Old English consonant phonemes. Hogg discusses these as OE consonant changes that are not broadly West Germanic (Hogg 1992, sects 7.18–7.23).

Old English i-umlaut and its context: The i-umlaut (SC055) is one of the most productive changes in the Old English nominal and verbal morphology. Its relative chronology in relation to breaking, palatalization, and back-mutation is carefully documented in the existing CAPR chronology evidence audit and individual dossiers (Campbell 1959, sects 193–204; Hogg 1992, sects 5.62–5.68).

Late Old English syllabic reduction and apocope: High-vowel apocope (SC063), medial syncope (SC065), and the cluster of late unstressed-vowel changes (SC069–SC078) represent the later stage of Old English phonological history, when the syllabic structure of the language began to shift toward the more reduced profile of Middle English.

34.4 Cascade positions and historical order

Chapters in this part of the book follow the executable cascade order, which models the reconstructed chronology, so every section in this chapter appears at its cascade position. A few rules presented here carry stage labels from earlier periods; their individual sections discuss the label and its history, and a later renaming pass will resolve the residue:

- SC041 (PWGmc Final Bare-**a* Loss) and SC042 (Surviving Bimoric **ō* Unrounding) carry Proto-West Germanic labels but execute in this stretch of the cascade.
- SC064 (NWGmc **-n* Stem **n* Loss) carries a Northwest Germanic label but executes after OE High-Vowel Apocope (SC063).
- SC049 (PGmc B Allophony) carries a Proto-Germanic label but executes here.

34.5 Sources

Campbell's *Old English Grammar* is the primary source for the dating and scope of individual changes in this chapter (Campbell 1959). Hogg's *Grammar of Old English* provides modern reassessments and additional relative-chronology evidence (Hogg 1992). Ringe and Taylor supply the most detailed relative-chronology analysis for the earlier portion of the chapter, through back-mutation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 70–160). Fulk's *Comparative Grammar* provides additional coverage for morphological conditioning (Fulk 2018). For individual changes, source-specific citations appear in the relevant sound-change sections.

35 Awj glide formation and au-fronting

35.1 Historical discussion

The *hīeg* ‘hay’ and *strīegan* ‘strew’ material undergoes both changes. Glide formation reshapes the older *awj* sequence, and fronting then affects the resulting *au*. Campbell's discussion of these outcomes and Ringe and Taylor's derivations of *hīeg* and *strīegan* describe the same sequence (Campbell 1959, 46, §120; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 188).

Glide formation creates the input to fronting; diphthong leveling follows both.

35.2 Historical discussion of awj glide formation

Older *awj* sequences are the source of forms such as *hīeg* ‘hay’ and *strīegan* ‘strew’. Campbell treats the relevant developments directly, and Ringe and Taylor likewise trace the same material through intermediate *auj*-type stages (Campbell 1959, 46, §120; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 188).

The sources establish glide formation, while the witness forms supply only a later boundary.

35.3 SC029. Glide formation in **awj* (OEAwjGlideFormation)

```
define OEAwjGlideFormation [
  { *á } { *w } { *w } { *j } -> { *áu } { *j },
  { *a } { *w } { *w } { *j } -> { *au } { *j },
  { *á } { *w } { *j } -> { *áu } { *j },
  { *a } { *w } { *j } -> { *au } { *j }
];
```

The *hīeg* ‘hay’ and *strīegan* ‘strew’ derivations show that *awj* reshaping prepared the input to fronting. If fronting is applied first, PGmc **xáwwjɑ* ‘hay’ yields *†hauǵ* rather than expected OE *hīeg* ‘hay’, and PGmc **stráwwjanɑ* ‘strew’ yields *†strauian* rather than expected *strīegan* ‘strew’. Earlier placement of glide formation changes no output, so these forms supply an upper boundary without a corresponding lower one.

35.4 Historical discussion of au-fronting

Once the glide sequence is in place, *au*-fronting produces the fronted diphthongal outcomes of the broader West Saxon vowel history. Campbell describes *au* > *ēa* (Campbell 1959, 53–54, §135).

Fronting must follow glide formation and precede diphthong leveling, which applies to a wider set of derivations.

35.5 SC030. Fronting of **au* (OE AuFronting)

```
define OEAuFronting [  
    {*au} -> {*aeu},  
    {*áú} -> {*áeu}  
];
```

Two distinct failure sets confine fronting. Placed before glide formation, it produces the wrong forms: PGmc **xáwwjɑ* ‘hay’ yields *†haug* rather than expected OE *hīeg* ‘hay’, and PGmc **stráw-jaŋɑ* ‘strew’ yields *†strauian* rather than expected *striēgan* ‘strew’. Placed after diphthong leveling, PGmc **galáubijanɑ* ‘believe’, **bráudɑ* ‘bread’, and **dráugmaz* ‘dream’, together with sixteen other derivations, fail to produce output at all (+?) instead of yielding expected OE *gēliefan* ‘believe’, *brēad* ‘bread’, and *drēam* ‘dream’. The lexical errors require fronting to follow glide formation, while the failed derivations require it to precede diphthong leveling.

The later failure set consists of failed derivations, not competing Old English surface forms.

36 Long ēow before following vowels

36.1 Historical discussion

Four distinct developments shape the West Saxon diphthongal field. Campbell discusses inherited *aw/ew* outcomes, palatal-triggered diphthongization, and later Anglian smoothing in connected but separate parts of the vowel history; Hogg likewise distinguishes the palatal-diphthongal developments (Campbell 1959, 46, 53–54, 65–70, 95–96, §§120, 135–136, 170–176, 185, 223–227; Hogg 1992, 106–7, 111–12).

The closest interaction joins *ww*-simplification and long-*aw* diphthongization, which together shape *dēaw* ‘dew’ and *hēawan* ‘hew’. Diphthong leveling regularizes a wider field, while long-*ew* diphthongization carries *ēow* into the later environment of breaking.

The long *ēow* forms of *cēowan* ‘chew’, *fēower* ‘four’, and *cnēow* ‘knee’ form part of the West Saxon vowel history, although their clearest ordering relation points forward. Campbell describes early *eu* in Old English, and Ringe and Taylor give the corresponding examples from chew, four, and knee (Campbell 1959, 53–54, §136; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 188, 202).

The only boundary established by the lexical evidence for SC033 OEEwLongDiphthong lies ahead at SC044 OEBreaking.

36.2 SC033. Long ēow before following vowels and weak endings (OEEwLongDiphthong)

```
define OEEwLongDiphthong [  
  {*e} {*w} -> {*ēo} {*w} || _ OEEwLongContext,  
  {*i} {*w} -> {*ēo} {*w} || _ OEEwLongContext,  
  {*é} {*w} -> {*ēo} {*w} || _ OEEwLongContext,  
  {*ī} {*w} -> {*ēo} {*w} || _ OEEwLongContext  
];
```

The long *ēow* of *cēowan* ‘chew’, *fēower* ‘four’, and *cnēow* ‘knee’ supplies only a terminus ante quem. If SC033 OEEwLongDiphthong follows SC044 OEBreaking, PGmc **kéwwanq* ‘chew’ yields [†]*cēowan* rather than expected OE *cēowan* ‘chew’, PGmc **fédwōr* ‘four’ yields [†]*feower* rather than expected *fēower* ‘four’, and PGmc **knéwq* ‘knee’ yields [†]*cneow* rather than expected *cnēow* ‘knee’. Earlier placement changes no output. The sources associate *ew* and *iw* with the same diphthongal history but furnish no lower boundary.

37 Simplification of **ww* sequences

37.1 Historical discussion

West Germanic *ww* sequences lie behind forms such as *dēaw* ‘dew’ and *hēawan* ‘hew’, and Campbell treats them as part of the early West Germanic diphthong history (Campbell 1959, 46, §120).

SC031 OEWWsimplification precedes the later long-diphthong outcomes.

37.2 SC031. Simplification of **ww* sequences (OEWWsimplification)

```
define OEWWsimplification [  
    {*w} {*w} -> {*w}  
];
```

The *dēaw* ‘dew’ and *hēawan* ‘hew’ derivations establish that doubled *w* was simplified before the long *ēaw* development. If SC031 OEWWsimplification follows SC034 OEAwLongDiphthong, PGmc **dāwwō* ‘dew’ yields [†]*dawu* rather than expected OE *dēaw* ‘dew’, and PGmc **xāwwaną* ‘hew’ yields [†]*hawan* rather than expected *hēawan* ‘hew’. Earlier placement changes no output. The witnesses require simplification before the long-diphthong change and leave the lower boundary to the broader West Saxon chronology.

38 Leveling of diphthongal outputs

38.1 Historical discussion

Forms such as *hēafod* ‘head’ reflect the redistribution of diphthongal outcomes across a wider set of words. Campbell describes smoothing and related later monophthongization, although the rule below is more narrowly conditioned than any single textbook label (Campbell 1959, 95–96, §§223–227).

The evidence for SC032 OEDiphthongLeveling is less self-contained than that for the *dēaw* ‘dew’ / *hēawan* ‘hew’ developments.

38.2 SC032. Leveling of diphthongal outputs (OEDiphthongLeveling)

```
define OEDiphthongLeveling [  
  {*aeu} -> {*ēa},  
  {*áeu} -> {*ēa},  
  {*eu} -> {*ēo},  
  {*éu} -> {*ēo},  
  {*iu} -> {*ēo},  
  {*íu} -> {*ēo},  
  {*e} {*u} -> {*eo},  
  {*é} {*u} -> {*éo},  
  {*i} {*u} -> {*eo}  
];
```

The two edges of this interval fail differently. Before SC030 OEAuFronting, PGmc **galáubijanq* ‘believe’, **báug* ‘bow’, and **bráudq* ‘bread’ produce no output (+?) instead of expected OE *gēliefan* ‘believe’, *bēag* ‘bow’, and *brēad* ‘bread’, alongside fifteen other failed derivations. After SC040 OEmedUnstressedULowering, PGmc **xáubudq* ‘head’ yields [†]*hēafud* rather than expected *hēafod* ‘head’. Absence at the lower edge places diphthong leveling after fronting; the wrong surface form at the upper edge places it before medial unstressed-*u* lowering.

39 Long *ēaw* before following vowels

39.1 Historical discussion

After SC031 OEWWsimplification has reduced *ww* to single *w*, the remaining *aw* sequence can develop into the long *ēaw* seen in *dēaw* ‘dew’ and *hēawan* ‘hew’. Campbell treats these outputs in the early diphthong history of West Germanic and Old English (Campbell 1959, 46, 53–54, §§120, 135–136). The resulting long diphthong is *ēaw*.

SC034 OEAwLongDiphthong follows SC031 OEWWsimplification locally and must also precede SC043 EAFBrightening.

39.2 SC034. Long *ēaw* before following vowels (OEAwLongDiphthong)

```
define OEAwLongDiphthong [  
  {*a} {*w} -> {*ēa} {*w} || _ [EnglishStarVocalic | {*ō}],  
  {*á} {*w} -> {*ēá} {*w} || _ [EnglishStarVocalic | {*ō}]  
];
```

A local feeding relation and a later vowel change confine *aw* > *ēaw*. Before SC031 OEWWsimplification, PGmc **dāwwō* ‘dew’ yields [†]*dawu* rather than expected OE *dēaw* ‘dew’, and PGmc **xáwwanq* ‘hew’ yields [†]*hawan* rather than expected *hēawan* ‘hew’. After SC043 EAFBrightening, PGmc **skáwōjanq* ‘show’ yields [†]*scawian* rather than expected OE *scēawian* ‘show’, PGmc **skáwōθi* ‘shows’ yields [†]*scawaþ* rather than expected *scēawaþ* ‘shows’, and PGmc **stráwq* ‘straw’ yields [†]*stræw* rather than expected *strēaw* ‘straw’. The *dēaw* and *hēawan* forms require long-diphthong formation after simplification, while *scēawian* requires it before brightening; the handbooks assign the same interval to the West Saxon development.

40 Prefix and compound adjustments

40.1 Historical discussion of prefixal **a*-reduction

Weakly stressed prefixes can lose their older low vowel early in Old English, and that is the historical setting for SC035 OEPrefixAReduction. Campbell treats the small class of pretonic losses directly, while Ringe and Taylor's derivation of **galaubijana* 'believe' supplies the comparative witness for the same development (Campbell 1959, 147, §354; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 245; 2014, 267).

The rule has a narrow historical range and gives prefixed forms the weak vowel inherited by later vocalic changes.

40.2 SC035. Reduction of prefixal **a* (OEPrefixAReduction)

```
define OEPrefixAReduction [  
  {*a} -> {*ë}  
  || .#. {*g} _  
    [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]  
    EnglishStarVocalic  
];
```

The prefix of *ġeliefan* 'believe' supplies the upper boundary for **ga-* > **ge-*. If SC035 OEPrefixAReduction follows SC043 EAFBrightening, PGmc **galáubijanā* 'believe' yields *†ġealtiefan* rather than expected OE *ġeliefan* 'believe'. Earlier placement changes no output, so the witness dates prefix reduction before brightening without locating its beginning.

40.3 Historical discussion of inter-stress raising

SC036 OEInterStressRaising has the strongest evidence of the three. Campbell's discussion of *weorold* 'world' / *weoruld* 'world' and Ringe and Taylor's derivation of **weraldu* 'world' > **weruldu* 'world' > OE *weorold* place the rule squarely in the history of low-stress medial vowels (Campbell 1959, 141–42, §§338–339; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 322, §6.3.3).

The rule changes the vowel between stronger stress peaks, and its witnesses consequently constrain the relative chronology.

40.4 SC036. Raising of medial **a* between stress peaks (OEInterStressRaising)

```
define OEInterStressRaising [  
  {*a} -> {*u}  
  || PGmcStarVowel EnglishStarConsonant*  
    [EnglishStarConsonant - {*j}]+ [{*u}][{*ū}],  
  {*à} -> {*u}  
];
```

The two boundaries have unequal force. Before SC019 PNWGMcFinalLongORaising, PGmc **sái-walō* 'soul' yields *†sāwel* rather than expected OE *sāwol* 'soul'; after SC040 OEmedUnstressedU-Lowering, it yields *†sāwul* rather than *sāwol*, while PGmc **wír-àldu* 'world' yields *†weoruld* rather than *weorold* 'world'. The distant lower boundary places inter-stress raising after final long-*o* raising, and the local upper boundary places it before medial unstressed-*u* lowering. In handbook terms, medial **a* > **u* belongs to the *world-* and *soul-* type low-stress vocalism that followed the earlier final-vowel changes.

40.5 Historical discussion of compound linking syncope

Compound members with weakened force often lose or reshape their linking vowels, and Campbell treats that broad pattern through reduced second elements, connecting vowels, and obscured compounds (Campbell 1959, 148–49, §§356–357; Campbell 1959, 153, §367; Campbell 1959, 159, §§386–387).

SC037 `OECompoundLinkingSyncope` captures this pattern in compounds such as *reǵnboga* ‘rainbow’. The only boundary the lexical evidence supplies is the immediately following technical stress-stripping stage, which is not a sound change.

40.6 SC037. Syncope of compound linking vowels (`OECompoundLinkingSyncope`)

```
define OECompoundLinkingSyncope [  
  [{*a}|{*i}|{*u}] -> 0  
  || PGmcStarAcuteVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _  
  OEAnyConsonant+ PGmcStarGraveVowel  
];
```

The *reǵnboga* ‘rainbow’ test exposes a bookkeeping dependency rather than a historical sound-change boundary. After SC038 `OEStripSecondaryStress`, PGmc **régna-bùgô* ‘rainbow’ yields *†reǵnefoga* rather than expected OE *reǵnboga* ‘rainbow’, because the technical stage has erased the stress information that licenses syncope. The handbooks instead place weakened compound junctures with the behavior described under SC035 `OEPrefixAReduction` and SC036 `OEInterStressRaising`.

41 Medial unstressed vowel changes

41.1 Historical discussion

The history of *wuduwe* ‘widow’ orders these two changes within the same low-stress vocalic development. Campbell discusses both the *w*-conditioned *u* forms and the later *weorold* ‘world’ / *weoruld* ‘world’ alternation, while Ringe and Taylor give the same connection comparatively in **widuwon-*, **weraldu* ‘world’, and **jugunþi* ‘youth’ (Campbell 1959, 92, §218; Campbell 1959, 140, §332; Campbell 1959, 141–42, §§338–339; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 267; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 322, §6.3.3).

SC039 OEWICombinativeUUmlaut feeds the vowel sequence subsequently reshaped by SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering. Initial *w* conditions the first change.

41.2 SC039. Combinative **u*-umlaut in *wi*-forms (OEWICombinativeUUmlaut)

```
define OEWICombinativeUUmlaut [  
  {*i} -> {*ú}  
  || .#. {*w} _ EnglishStarConsonant [{*u} | {*o}]  
];
```

The *wuduwe* ‘widow’ derivation answers one narrow question about *wi*-forms. If SC039 OEWICombinativeUUmlaut follows SC040 OEMedUnstressedULowering, PGmc **wíduwōn* ‘widow’ yields [†]*wudowe* rather than expected OE *wuduwe*; earlier placement changes no output. The witness requires combinative u-umlaut to precede medial lowering and supplies no lower boundary.

41.3 SC040. Lowering of medial unstressed **u* (OEMedUnstressedULowering)

```
define OEMedUnstressedULowering [  
  {*u} -> {*o}  
  || [EnglishStarVocalic - [{*u}|{*ū}|{*ú}]]  
  [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _  
  [[EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant] - {*m}]  
];
```

The two witnesses date medial unstressed **u* > **o* at very different scales. Before SC039 OEWICombinativeUUmlaut, PGmc **wíduwōn* ‘widow’ yields [†]*wudowe* rather than expected OE *wuduwe* ‘widow’; after SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, PGmc **júgunθ* ‘youth’ yields [†]*ġeogop* rather than expected *ġeogup* ‘youth’. The local *weorold* ‘world’ and widow evidence places lowering after combinative u-umlaut, while the youth form supplies only the distant requirement that lowering precede unstressed long-vowel shortening.

42 Final bare-*a* loss

42.1 Historical discussion

I isolate the loss of final short low vowels within the broader erosion of final syllables described by the handbooks (Campbell 1959, 143, §341; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 60–61).

Final bare-*a* loss follows the medial unstressed vowel changes and precedes restoration, which depends on the environment left by the loss.

42.2 SC041. Loss of final bare **a* (PWGmcFinalBareALoss)

```
define PWGmcFinalBareALoss [  
  {*a} -> 0 || _ .#.  
];
```

The two sides of final bare-*a* loss rest on different evidence. Applied before final *z*-deletion, the change gives the wrong outputs: PGmc **bárdaz* ‘beard’ yields [†]*bearda* rather than expected OE *beard* ‘beard’, and PGmc **kámbaz* ‘comb’ yields [†]*camba* rather than expected *camb* ‘comb’. Applied after restoration, PGmc **kráftaz* ‘craft’ yields [†]*craft* rather than expected OE *cræft* ‘craft’, and PGmc **dágaz* ‘day’ yields [†]*dag* rather than expected *dæg* ‘day’. The distant lower limit follows final *z*-loss; the local feeding relation precedes restoration, which requires the environment created by the vowel loss.

43 Surviving bimoric **ō* unrounding

43.1 Historical discussion

The handbooks do not isolate a large independent sound change under this label. The surviving bimoric **ō* in the pathway to *ræste* ‘rest’ nevertheless undergoes unrounding before SC043 EAFBrightening. Campbell, Hogg, and Ringe and Taylor describe the surrounding fronting and restoration history without naming this feeder separately (Campbell 1959, 52, 60, §§131, 157–158; Hogg 1992, 101, 119; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 157–58, 189–90).

The sole witness establishes a local relation to brightening but supports no broader generalization.

43.2 SC042. Unrounding of the surviving bimoric **ō* (PWGmcSurvivingBimoricOUnrounding)

```
define PWGmcSurvivingBimoricOUnrounding [  
  { *ō } -> { *ā } || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |  
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ .#.  
];
```

The single *ræste* ‘rest’ derivation carries the chronology of bimoric **ō* > **ā*. Before SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion or after SC043 EAFBrightening, PGmc **rástōz* ‘rest’ yields [†]*rasta* rather than expected OE *ræste*. Unrounding must therefore follow final z-loss and precede brightening, although only the relation to brightening is local.

44 Anglo-Frisian brightening

44.1 Historical discussion

Anglo-Frisian Brightening or First Fronting turns low **a* into fronted **æ*-type outcomes outside nasal environments. Later Old English developments presuppose this fronted stage even where they partly conceal it. Campbell gives the classical statement of the change, Hogg supplies the standard modern labels, and Ringe and Taylor establish its local chronology with breaking and restoration (Campbell 1959, 52, §131; Hogg 1992, 101, 119; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 157–58, 189–90; Fulk 2018, 73–74, §§4.12–4.13).

Brightening creates the input to SC044 OEBreaking, while SC046 OEARestoration later partly reverses its outcome before back vowels.

44.2 SC043. Fronting of low **a* outside nasal environments (EAFBrightening)

```
define EAFBrightening [  
  AngloFrisianBrighteningUnstressed .o.  
  AngloFrisianBrighteningStressed .o.  
  AngloFrisianBrighteningLongFinal  
];
```

Two derivations place low **a* > **æ* between unrounding and breaking. Before SC042 PWGmc-SurvivingBimoricOUnrounding, PGmc **rástōz* ‘rest’ yields [†]*rasta* rather than expected OE *ræste* ‘rest’. After SC044 OEBreaking, PGmc **sláxanq* ‘slay’ yields *sleaan* | *slēaan* rather than expected OE *slēan* ‘slay’. The first witness requires brightening to receive the outcome of the surviving-bimoric **ō* development; the second requires breaking to receive the fronted vowel.

45 Breaking and velar-fricative palatalization

45.1 Historical discussion

Breaking creates *eo*-type outputs before *h*, *rC*, and *lC*; velar-fricative palatalization then operates in that reshaped environment. Campbell, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk place breaking after brightening. The following fricative palatalization is more narrowly conditioned (Campbell 1959, 54, 166, §§139, 405–406; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 168–69, 213–14, §§6.2.1–6.2.3, 6.4.1–6.4.2; Fulk 2018, 73–74, §4.13).

Breaking has the fuller handbook treatment, while velar-fricative palatalization follows it locally in the *feoh* ‘cattle’ and *feohtan* ‘fight’ type derivations.

45.2 SC044. Breaking before *h*, *rC*, and *lC* (OEBreaking)

```
define OEBreaking OEBreakingA
  .o. OEBreakingE
  .o. OEBreakingI;
```

Breaking must encounter the vowel created by brightening and must precede the fricative change seen in *feoh* ‘fee’ and *feohtan* ‘fight’. Before SC043 EAFBrightening, PGmc **sláxanq* ‘slay’ yields *sleaan* | *slēaan* rather than expected OE *slēan* ‘slay’. After SC045 OEVelarFricativePalatalization, PGmc **féxu* ‘cattle’ yields *†fehu* rather than expected OE *feoh*, and PGmc **féxtanq* ‘fight’ yields *†fehtan* rather than expected *feohtan*. The two feeding relations place breaking between brightening and velar-fricative palatalization.

45.3 SC045. Palatalization of velar fricatives beside front vowels (OEVelarFricativePalatalization)

```
define OEVelarFricativePalatalization [
  { *x } -> { *ç } || _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
  { *ɣ } -> { *j } || _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
  { *x } -> { *ç } || EnglishStarFrontVowel _,
  { *ɣ } -> { *j } || EnglishStarFrontVowel _,
  { *x } -> { *ç } || _ { *j },
  { *ɣ } -> { *j } || _ { *j }
]
```

```
.o. EnglishStarAlphabet*;
```

The local chronology comes from *feoh* ‘cattle’ and *feohtan* ‘fight’. Before SC044 OEBreaking, palatalization of **x* and **ɣ* beside front vowels or **j* makes PGmc **féxu* ‘cattle’ yield *†fehu* rather than expected OE *feoh*, and PGmc **féxtanq* ‘fight’ yield *†fehtan* rather than expected *feohtan*. The distant upper limit comes from *six* ‘six’: after SC060 OEWsPalatalUmlaut, PGmc **séxs* ‘six’ yields *†sihs* rather than expected OE *six*. Breaking therefore feeds velar-fricative palatalization directly, while palatal umlaut supplies only the broader upper limit.

46 A-restoration and nasal changes

46.1 Historical discussion of A-restoration

Campbell's restoration of *a* before following back vowels and Ringe and Taylor's later retraction describe the same post-brightening development (Campbell 1959, 60–61, §§157–159; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 189–90, §6.3.1; Fulk 2018, 74, §4.13). Some outcomes of Anglo-Frisian fronting survive only in environments where restoration does not return them to back *a*.

SC046 OEARestoration has firmer handbook support than the two following nasal rules.

46.2 SC046. Restoration of **a* before following back vowels (OEARestoration)

```
define OEARestoration (
  { *æ } -> { *a } || _
    OEARestorationIntervening OEARestorationTriggerVowel
  - OEARestorationIntervening OEARestorationWeakTailVowel
);
```

Restoration must receive fronted **æ* and return **a* before the nasal-tail changes. Before SC043 EAFBrightening, PGmc **bákanq* 'bake' yields [†]*bæcan* rather than expected OE *bacan* 'bake', and PGmc **fáranq* 'fare' yields [†]*færan* rather than expected *faran* 'fare'. After SC048 OESecondaryNasalization, **bákanq* again yields [†]*bæcan* instead of *bacan*, while PGmc **wádanq* 'wade' yields [†]*wædan* instead of *wadan* 'wade'. These independent witness pairs place restoration after brightening and before secondary nasalization.

46.3 Historical discussion of heavy-syllable nasal loss and secondary nasalization

Heavy-syllable nasal apocope removes the final nasalized vowel; secondary nasalization then marks the preceding *a* before final *n*. The handbooks do not isolate both developments under equally prominent labels. Campbell describes later nasal loss and the back-mutation environment; Ringe and Taylor provide the later relation to back mutation (Campbell 1959, 86, 166, §§205–206, 403; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 319, §6.9.4).

The reciprocal failure set fixes the order: apocope removes the ending before secondary nasalization acts on the remaining structure. Restoration receives the fuller historical treatment in the handbooks.

46.4 SC047. Heavy-syllable nasal apocope of final **q* (OEHeavySyllableNasalApocope)

```
define OEHeavySyllableNasalApocope [
  { *q } -> Ø || OEAnyConsonant _ .#.
];
```

The evidence for final nasalized **q* loss is sharply asymmetric. Before SC034 OEAwLongDiphthong, the single PGmc witness **stráwq* 'straw' yields [†]*stræw* rather than expected OE *strēaw* 'straw'. After SC048 OESecondaryNasalization, PGmc **bákanq* 'bake' yields [†]*bacen* rather than expected OE *bacan* 'bake', and PGmc **bīdanq* 'bind' yields [†]*bīden* rather than expected *bindan* 'bind', alongside a broad *-en* failure set. One lower witness places apocope after long-diphthong formation; many reciprocal upper failures place it before secondary nasalization.

46.5 SC048. Secondary nasalization before final **n* (OESecondaryNasalization)

```
define OESecondaryNasalization [  
    {*a} -> {*ǣ} || _ {*n} .#.  
];
```

The broad *-an/-en* split fixes the lower boundary of final **a* nasalization before *n*. Before SC047 OEHeavySyllableNasalApocope, PGmc **bákaną* ‘bake’ yields *†bacen* rather than expected OE *bacan* ‘bake’, and PGmc **bīdaną* ‘bind’ yields *†binden* rather than expected *bindan* ‘bind’. The upper boundary comes from back mutation. After SC059 OEBackMutation, PGmc **stélaną* ‘steal’ yields *†steolan* rather than expected OE *stelan* ‘steal’, and PGmc **wébaną* ‘weave’ yields *†weofan* rather than expected *wefan* ‘weave’. Reciprocal nasal-tail failures place secondary nasalization after apocope, and the later mutation witnesses place it before back mutation; SC046 OEARestoration retains the clearest independent historical support.

47 B allophony

47.1 Historical discussion

The positional alternation of Germanic **b* is a Proto-Germanic distributional feature. Hogg states the Old English distribution clearly: /b/ is a stop initially, after nasals, and in gemination, while the same segment is otherwise realized as a voiced bilabial fricative (Hogg 1992, 101–2). Ringe and Taylor support the broader West Germanic background by treating Proto-West-Germanic **b* as a segment whose stop and fricative values depend on position (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 121), and Luick’s spelling evidence shows the same labial fricative pattern in Old English (Luick 1914–1940, 107).

The distribution is narrow, but later changes presuppose the stop-fricative alternation. CAPR implements the rule at a late cascade position for computational reasons: the alternation must interact with consonant environments shaped by intermediate rule applications. Its historical stage is Proto-Germanic.

47.2 SC049. Distribution of **b* after vowels and liquids (PGmcBAllophony)

```
define PGmcBAllophony [  
  {*b} -> {*β} || PGmcStarVocalic _,  
  {*b} -> {*β} || [{*l} | {*r}] _  
] .o. [  
  {*β} -> {*b} || _ {*b}  
];
```

The handbooks describe **b*/**bb* as a positional alternation within the consonant system, and one compound supplies its chronological consequence. Before SC037 OECompoundLinkingSyncope, *reġnboga* ‘rainbow’ develops as *†reġnfoga* rather than expected OE *reġnboga*; later placement creates no comparable failure. The witness places b-allophony after compound-linking syncope without turning the alternation into an independent sound law.

48 Sievers-law syncope

48.1 Historical discussion

Sievers' Law concerns a prosodic and morphological adjustment in heavy stems. It is a distributional rule distinct from b-allophony (SC049 PGmcBALlophony). Adamczyk treats the Old English reflexes of the law as historical evidence from weak verbs and related formations (Adamczyk 2001, 61–72). Fulk gives the compact comparative summary through familiar forms such as *bid-dan* 'ask', *sellan* 'give', and *nerian* 'save' (Fulk 2018, 127, §6.15).

Sievers-law syncope is narrow in scope, but its relation to the following palatalization is lexically secure. Its earlier limit is less sharply defined than that of the preceding allophony rule.

48.2 SC050. Sievers-law syncope (SieversLawSyncope)

```
define SieversLawSyncope [  
  {*i} -> 0 || [EnglishStarConsonant | EnglishPalatalConsonant] _ {*j}  
];
```

The Sievers-law reduction **-CijV-** > **-CjV-**, including loss of **i* before **j*, must precede palatalization. If SC050 SieversLawSyncope follows SC052 OEVelarPalatalization, PGmc **strákkijaną* 'stretch' yields [†]*streccan* rather than expected OE *streccan* 'stretch'; earlier placement creates no comparably precise error. The single cluster witness therefore places syncope before velar palatalization.

49 Palatalization of **sk* to **sc*

49.1 Historical discussion

The palatalization of **sk* to Old English **sc* is one of the recognizable early cluster changes in the larger palatalization zone. Campbell distinguishes the cluster from plain velars when he remarks that **sk* is especially prone to palatalization and assibilation (Campbell 1959, 278, §440). Hogg gives the same change a clearer structural place by treating **sk* beside the palatalization of plain velars and before the later West Saxon diphthongal developments (Hogg 1992, 106–7, 111–12). Ringe and Taylor make the same sequence explicit when they distinguish the earlier palatalization of velars and **sk* from the later diphthongization after already palatal consonants (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 213–16, §§6.4.1, 6.5.1).

Luick places the cluster change within a broader early movement toward palatal articulation, while still allowing later vowel consequences to form a different chapter of the history (Luick 1914–1940, 157, §168). Fulk’s summary is the most concise warning against overextension: Old English **sc* is palatal except in the well-known back-vowel environments that preserve harder outcomes (Fulk 2018, 28). The result is a historically clear rule, but not an identity between the cluster change and the later umlautal developments.

49.2 SC051. Palatalization of **sk* to **sc* (OESkPalatalization)

```
define OESkPalatalization [
  {*s} {*k} -> {*ʃ} || .#. _
] .o. [
  {*s} {*k} -> {*ʃ} || EnglishStarFrontVowel _ (EnglishStarConsonant | .#. )
] .o. [
  {*s} {*k} -> {*ʃ} || (EnglishStarConsonant | .#. ) _ EnglishStarFrontVowel
] .o. [
  {*s} {*k} -> {*ʃ} || _ {*j}
] .o. [
  {*s} {*k} -> {*ʃ} || {*j} _
];
```

The non-fronted vowels of *flasce* ‘flask’ and *wascan* ‘wash’ fix the lower boundary of **sk* > **sc*. Before SC046 OEAREstoration, the forms are fronted too soon, yielding *flæsce* ‘flask’ and *wæscan* ‘wash’ rather than expected OE *flasce* and *wascan*. This places SC051 OESkPalatalization after restoration.

Five witnesses establish the upper boundary collectively. The palatal cluster must already underlie *sceaft* ‘shaft’, *scēar* ‘shear’, *scēap* ‘sheath’, *scēap* ‘sheep’, and *sciold* ‘shield’ before SC056 OEWsPalatalDiphthongization. The **scea-* ‘sea’/**scie-* set therefore places cluster palatalization before the West Saxon vowel change. The cluster change occupies the same palatalization zone as SC052 OEVelarPalatalization while remaining distinct from plain-velar palatalization and the later vowel changes.

50 Velar palatalization before front vowels

50.1 Historical discussion

Luick places the change inside a broad early palatalizing movement. Under the heading “Frühe Verschiebungen in palataler Richtung,” he treats English *k* and *g* before bright vowels together with the larger field of palatal effects (Luick 1914–1940, 157, §168). His emphasis falls on the environment first: velars before bright vowels and in the vicinity of the palatal glide belong to one early phonological sequence. The examples associated with that sequence, such as *ceaster* ‘town’, *geaf* ‘gave’, *giefan* ‘give’, and *giest* ‘guest’, already show that consonantal palatalization and later vowel effects stand close together historically, even when they must be distinguished analytically (Luick 1914–1940, 157–67, §§168–182).

Campbell narrows the picture by distinguishing plain velars from the especially palatal-prone *sk* cluster. His remark that “[*sk*] is more prone to palatalization and assibilation than [*k*]” is brief, but it makes clear that different members of the larger palatal field need not behave identically (Campbell 1959, 278, §440). Elsewhere in the same part of the grammar he uses forms such as *cild* ‘child’, *dæg* ‘day’, *giefan* ‘give’, and *giest* ‘guest’, which show how palatalized velars, palatal influence, and later umlautal outcomes meet in the same region of the lexicon without collapsing into one process (Campbell 1959, 69–72, 89, §§170, 190–191).

Hogg makes the conditioning sharper still. He states that the change takes place when the velar consonant is adjacent to and in the same syllable as a front vowel or the palatal consonant *j* (Hogg 1992, 103–4). This formulation replaces a broad list of palatal outcomes with a phonological environment defined by adjacency and syllable structure.

Ringe and Taylor make the chronological relation still clearer. When they write that “after initial velars and **sk* had been palatalized” West-Saxon diphthongization follows, plain velar palatalization becomes an earlier consonantal stage presupposed by later vowel developments (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215, §6.5.1). Their own examples of the plain-velar rule, such as *weccan* ‘wake’, *licgan* ‘lie’, *lecgan* ‘lay’, *secg* ‘retainer’, *ecg* ‘edge’, *wicg* ‘horse’, and *brycg* ‘bridge’, illustrate the same point in lexical detail: front vowels and *j* create the palatal environment in which plain *k* and *g* cease to behave as plain velars (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 213–14, §6.4.1).

Luick describes a broad early movement; Campbell distinguishes plain velars from the *sk* complex; Hogg specifies the adjacency and syllable conditions; and Ringe and Taylor order the plain-velar change before West-Saxon diphthongization. Plain-velar palatalization thus forms part of a wider palatalizing environment without being identical to its neighboring changes.

50.2 SC052. Palatalization of **k* before front vowels and **j* (OEVelarPalatalizationKFront)

```
define OEVelarPalatalizationKFront [
  {*k} -> {*tʃ} || .#. _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
  {*k} -> {*tʃ} || _ [{*i} | {*ī}],
  {*k} -> {*tʃ} || _ {*í},
  {*k} -> {*tʃ} || [{*i} | {*ī}] _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
  {*k} -> {*tʃ} || {*í} _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
  {*k} -> {*tʃ} || [{*i} | {*ī}] _ .#. ,
  {*k} -> {*tʃ} || {*í} _ .#.
] .o. [
  {*k} {*k} -> {*tʃ} {*tʃ} || _ {*j}
] .o. [
  {*k} -> {*tʃ} || _ {*j}
] ;
```

The *weccan* ‘wake’, *licgan* ‘lie’, and *lecgan* ‘lay’ set identifies front vowels and *j* as the environment for palatalization of *k* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 213–14, §6.4.1). These forms establish the conditioning; different witnesses establish the chronology.

Applied before Sievers-law syncope, PGmc **strákkijanq* ‘stretch’ yields [†]*strecċan* rather than expected OE *streċċan* ‘stretch’. Applied after i-umlaut fronting, PGmc **kūi* ‘cow’ and **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’ yield *ċy* ‘cows’ and *lunġen* ‘lungs’ rather than expected OE *cȳ* ‘cows’ and *lungen* ‘lungs’. The front-vowel k change therefore follows Sievers-law syncope and precedes i-umlaut fronting.

50.3 SC052. Velar palatalization before front vowels (OEVelarPalatalization)

```
define OEVelarPalatalization [
  OEVelarPalatalizationKFront
] .o. [
  {*g} -> {*ǥ} || _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
  {*g} -> {*ǥ} || EnglishStarFrontVowel _ .#. ,
  {*g} -> {*ǥ} || EnglishStarFrontVowel _ EnglishStarFrontVowel,
  {*g} -> {*ǥ} || EnglishStarFrontVowel _ [EnglishStarConsonant - {*j}],
  {*g} {*g} -> {*ǥ} {*ǥ} || _ {*j}
] .o. [
  {*g} -> {*ǥ} || _ {*j}
];
```

Plain k and g palatalization in front-vocalic and j-adjacent environments follows sk-palatalization and occupies a sharply defined pre-umlaut interval. Applied before Sievers-law syncope, PGmc **strákkijanq* ‘stretch’ yields [†]*strecċan* rather than expected OE *streċċan* ‘stretch’. Applied after general i-umlaut, PGmc **kūi* ‘cow’ yields [†]*ċy* rather than expected *cȳ* ‘cows’, and PGmc **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’ yields [†]*lunġen* rather than expected *lungen* ‘lungs’. These witnesses place velar palatalization after Sievers-law syncope and before umlaut.

Luick, Campbell, and Ringe and Taylor place *cild* ‘child’ and *dæg* ‘day’ in a consonantal palatalization that precedes later vowel fronting (Luick 1914–1940, 157, §168; Campbell 1959, 278, §440; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 203–15, §§6.4.1, 6.5.1). The umlautal developments therefore receive plain k and g already reshaped beside front vowels and j.

The sk change belongs to the same palatalizing region with a separate scope. The *streċċan* ‘stretch’ evidence establishes a specific dependency on earlier syncope; it does not merge the two changes into one process.

51 Post-velar *w-loss and loss of *w before final *i

51.1 Historical discussion

The first rule is a narrow loss of *w after velars in the *ngw sequence. Ringe and Taylor derive PGmc *singwan ‘sing’ to Old English *singan* ‘sing’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 214, §6.4.2). This comparative evidence establishes the change, although no lexical evidence fixes its order relative to a neighboring rule.

The second rule is historically more legible. Campbell notes the recurring loss of *w before *i in unstressed position (Campbell 1959, 167, §406). Ringe and Taylor trace the development of *sǣ* ‘sea’ from earlier *saiwi- / *sawi- (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 257, §6.7.1), and Luick gives the same trajectory in his own historical grammar (Luick 1914–1940, 173, §187). The first rule is restricted to the *ngw sequence; the second has a specific lexical witness and defined earlier and later limits.

51.2 SC053. Loss of *w after velars (OEPPostVelarWLoss)

```
define OEPPostVelarWLoss [  
  { *w } -> 0 || { *n } { *g } _  
];
```

The comparative development *singwan > *singan* establishes narrow post-velar *w-loss in the *ngw sequence, yielding *singan* ‘sing’. Moving SC053 OEPPostVelarWLoss earlier or later leaves every output unchanged. Its pre-umlaut position therefore rests on comparative evidence, while the present lexicon supplies no neighboring boundary.

51.3 SC054. Loss of *w before final *i (OEWLossBeforeI)

```
define OEWLossBeforeI [  
  { *w } -> 0 || EnglishStarVocalic _ { *i } .#.  
];
```

The history of *sǣ* ‘sea’ explains why non-initial *w disappeared before final unstressed *i. Campbell describes the loss, Ringe and Taylor derive the form from *saiwi-/ *sawi-, and Luick gives the parallel trajectory (Campbell 1959, 167, §406; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 257, §6.7.1; Luick 1914–1940, 173, §187). Loss of the glide allowed the preceding vowel to undergo the later fronting and lengthening.

The same witness supplies two distant limits. Before SC020 EAFFinalZDeletion or after SC063 OE-HighVowelApocope, SC054 OEWLossBeforeI yields †*sǣw* rather than expected OE *sǣ* ‘sea’. The loss must therefore follow final z-deletion and precede high-vowel apocope, while its exact position within that broad interval remains source-based.

52 The Old English i-umlaut and West Saxon palatal diphthongization

52.1 Historical discussion

Luick gives the change its traditional scale:

Der wichtigste Fall von palataler Beeinflussung ... war die Veränderung der urenglischen Vokale durch i oder j der Folgesilbe.

(Luick 1914–1940, 166–67, §182)

Campbell gives the most compact classical formulation in English when he writes that “the process known as i-umlaut or i-mutation operates on practically all the sounds which it could theoretically affect in OE” (Campbell 1959, 69, §190). He immediately defines the core conditioning environment as a following i or j, and he goes on to trace the consequences across much of the vowel system, including forms such as *giest* ‘guest’, *giefan* ‘give’, *hierde* ‘shepherd’, and *ieldra* ‘older’ (Campbell 1959, 69–72, §§190–197).

Hogg continues in the same vein: “we come now to a change which is almost as uncontroversial as it is important” (Hogg 1992, 112). His examples, such as *bryd* ‘bride’, *trymman* ‘strengthen’, *bedd* ‘bed’, *ciest* ‘chest’, and *wiersa* ‘worse’, likewise emphasize that the change is a broad redistribution of vowel quality across the Old English vowel system (Hogg 1992, 112–14).

The narrower palatal-diphthongal material is described differently. Ringe and Taylor treat West-Saxon diphthongization after initial palatals as a distinct process (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215, §6.5.1), and Fulk is even more explicit about its chronological delicacy when he calls it “diphthongization by initial palatal consonants (which precedes front umlaut but not breaking)” (Fulk 2018, 74, §4.13). Ringe and Taylor’s examples such as *gielðan* ‘pay’, *sciæld* ‘shield’, and *scieppan* ‘create’ show that this narrower process is triggered by already palatal consonants and leads to specifically West-Saxon diphthongal outputs (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–16, §6.5.1).

Luick, Campbell, and Hogg treat i-umlaut as a system-wide change. Ringe and Taylor and Fulk distinguish from it a narrower West-Saxon process affecting words after initial palatals. The two changes act in different environments and produce different lexical consequences.

52.2 SC055. Fronting under i-umlaut (OEIUmlautFronting)

```
define OEIUmlautFronting [  
  {*a} -> {*æ} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,  
  {*ā} -> {*æ} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,  
  {*e} -> {*i} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,  
  {*o} -> {*e} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,  
  {*ō} -> {*ē} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,  
  {*u} -> {*y} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,  
  {*ū} -> {*ȳ} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,  
  {*á} -> {*æ} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,  
  {*é} -> {*i} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,  
  {*ó} -> {*e} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,  
  {*ú} -> {*y} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger  
];
```

The breadth of i-umlaut appears in lexical classes that share only a following high front vocoid. The forms *fylgan* ‘follow’, *gylðen* ‘golden’, *wyrm* ‘worm’, and *giest* ‘guest’ exemplify the same i- or j-conditioned fronting across different vowels (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 222, §6.6.1; Campbell 1959, 69–72, §§190–191).

The cow and lung forms establish the lower boundary. If fronting precedes velar palatalization, PGmc **kūi* ‘cow’ yields [†]*čȳ* rather than expected OE *cȳ* ‘cows’, and **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’ yields [†]*lunġen* rather than expected OE *lunġen* ‘lungs’. The consonantal change must therefore precede fronting.

The gift and sheath forms establish the upper boundary. If West Saxon palatal diphthongization precedes fronting, PGmc **gēftiz* ‘gift’ yields [†]*gieft* rather than expected OE *gift* ‘gift’, and **skáiθiz* ‘sheath’ yields [†]*scāþ* rather than expected *scēap* ‘sheath’. Fronting consequently follows velar palatalization and precedes the West Saxon change; the other components of i-umlaut share those bounds.

52.3 SC055. Raising under i-umlaut (OEIUmlautRaising)

```
define OEIUmlautRaising [
  {*æ} -> {*e} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger
];
```

Raising of umlauted æ to e continues the same assimilatory event as fronting and therefore shares the chronology of general i-umlaut.

The same four forms fix both boundaries. If raising precedes velar palatalization, **kūi* ‘cow’ yields [†]*cȳ* instead of expected *cȳ* ‘cows’ and **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’ yields [†]*lunġen* instead of expected *lungen* ‘lungs’. If West Saxon palatal diphthongization precedes raising, **gēftiz* ‘gift’ yields [†]*gieft* rather than expected *gift* ‘gift’, and **skáiθiz* ‘sheath’ yields [†]*scāþ* rather than expected *scēap* ‘sheath’. These forms place raising after velar palatalization and before West Saxon palatal diphthongization.

The sources do not describe umlaut as simple fronting alone. Campbell notes that the low front vowel changes again before m and n in most dialects (Campbell 1959, 69, §190), and Hogg likewise treats short front vowels as part of the same assimilatory system (Hogg 1992, 112).

52.4 SC055. Diphthongal outcomes under i-umlaut (OEIUmlautDiphthong)

```
define OEIUmlautDiphthong [
  {*ea} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
  {*ēa} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
  {*io} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
  {*īo} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
  {*eo} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
  {*ēo} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
  {*ēa} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
  {*ēo} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger,
  {*īo} -> {*ie} || _ EnglishIUmlautIntervening EnglishIUmlautTrigger
];
```

Diphthongal outcomes belong to the same system-wide assimilation as simple-vowel fronting and raising. All three therefore belong to a single historical event.

The relevant examples are the recurring West-Saxon ie forms cited in the handbooks, including *giest* ‘guest’, *giefan* ‘give’, and *hierde* ‘shepherd’ in Campbell and *ciest* ‘chest’ in Hogg (Campbell 1959, 69–72, 78–80, §§190–191, 248–251; Hogg 1992, 112–14). These diphthongal outcomes form a distinct part of the general umlautal development alongside simple fronting.

The chronology comes from the cow/lung and gift/sheath contrasts. Placed before velar palatalization, diphthongal mutation over-palatalizes **kūi* ‘cow’ and **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’; placed after West Saxon palatal diphthongization, it yields [†]*gieft* and [†]*scāþ* instead of expected *gift* ‘gift’ and *scēap* ‘sheath’. These failures place diphthongal mutation after velar palatalization and before West Saxon palatal diphthongization.

52.5 SC055. The composite i-umlaut rule (OEIUmlaut)

```
define OEIUmlaut OEIUmlautFronting
.o. OEIUmlautRaising
```

The literature presents fronting, raising, and diphthongal mutation as effects of one historical development. They consequently occupy a single place in the Old English chronology.

The lower boundary is consonantal. If general umlaut precedes velar palatalization, PGmc **kui* ‘cow’ yields [†]*cȳ* rather than expected *cȳ* ‘cows’, and PGmc **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’ yields [†]*lunġen* rather than expected *lungen* ‘lungs’. These over-palatalized forms place general umlaut after velar palatalization.

The upper boundary separates general umlaut from the narrower West Saxon process. If West Saxon palatal diphthongization precedes umlaut, PGmc **gēftiz* ‘gift’ yields [†]*ġieft* rather than expected OE *ġift* ‘gift’, and **skáiθiz* ‘sheath’ yields [†]*scāþ* rather than expected *scēap* ‘sheath’. Together the two witness pairs place general umlaut after velar palatalization and before the West Saxon process.

52.6 SC056. West Saxon palatal diphthongization (OEWsPalatalDiphthongization)

```
define OEWsPalatalDiphthongization [
  { *æ } -> { *ea } || .#. [ { *tj } | { *ǥ } | { *f } | { *j } ] _ [EnglishStarConsonant |
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#. ],
  { *ǣ } -> { *ēa } || .#. [ { *tj } | { *ǥ } | { *f } | { *j } ] _ [EnglishStarConsonant |
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#. ],
  { *e } -> { *ie } || .#. [ { *tj } | { *ǥ } | { *f } | { *j } ] _ [EnglishStarConsonant |
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#. ],
  { *ē } -> { *iē } || .#. [ { *tj } | { *ǥ } | { *f } | { *j } ] _ [EnglishStarConsonant |
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#. ],
  { *é } -> { *iē } || .#. [ { *tj } | { *ǥ } | { *f } | { *j } ] _ [EnglishStarConsonant |
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#. ],
  { *ē } -> { *iē } || .#. [ { *tj } | { *ǥ } | { *f } | { *j } ] _ [EnglishStarConsonant |
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant | .#. ]
];
```

West Saxon *ġieldan* ‘pay’, *sciēld* ‘shield’, and *sciēppan* ‘create’ show diphthongization after an already palatal consonant (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–16, §6.5.1). Their dialectal and phonological restriction separates this development from system-wide i-umlaut.

Hogg’s *ġiefan* ‘give’ and *sceap* ‘sheep’ belong to the same palatal-consonant environment (Hogg 1992, 108–9). Fulk likewise assigns this diphthongization a place before front mutation and distinguishes the two processes (Fulk 2018, 74, §4.13).

The forms *ġift* ‘gift’ and *scēap* ‘sheath’ fix the lower boundary. If West Saxon palatal diphthongization precedes general i-umlaut, PGmc **gēftiz* ‘gift’ yields [†]*ġieft* rather than expected *ġift*, and PGmc **skáiθiz* ‘sheath’ yields [†]*scāþ* rather than expected *scēap*. These witnesses place West Saxon palatal diphthongization after general umlaut; no tested lexical item supplies a later terminus ante quem.

The one-sided chronology reflects the difference in scale. General umlaut reorganizes the vowel system, whereas West Saxon palatal diphthongization affects a narrower dialectal class after palatal consonants. Its exact later placement remains undemonstrated by the present lexicon.

53 J-cluster coalescence

53.1 Historical discussion

Only a small lexical group reveals the coalescence of velars with **j*. Plain-velar and **sk* palatalization must already have run before **gj* and **kj* acquire their later outcomes. Campbell, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk discuss the palatalized and fronted outcomes in *bīēgan* ‘bend’ and *sēcān* ‘seek’ without assigning this later cluster adjustment the status of a major sound law (Campbell 1959, 89, 107–8, §§170, 248–251; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 213–51, §§6.4.1, 6.5.1, 6.6.1–6.6.4; Fulk 2018, 65, 75, §§4.7, 4.13).

53.2 SC057. Coalescence of velar + **j* clusters (OEJClusterCoalescence)

```
define OEJClusterCoalescence (  
  [{*g} {*j} -> {*ǵ}]  
  .o. [{*k} {*j} -> {*č}]  
);
```

The forms *bīēgan* ‘bend’ and *sēcān* ‘seek’ determine the earlier boundary. If coalescence precedes SC052 OEVelarPalatalization, the developments behind *bīēgan* ‘bend’ and *sēcān* ‘seek’ are lost. Related forms such as *fylġan* ‘follow’, *hecġ* ‘hedge’, and *sengan* ‘sing’ fail in the same broader palatalization zone. PGmc **bāugijanq* ‘bow’ yields *†bēagan* rather than expected OE *bīēgan*, and PGmc **sōkijanq* ‘seek’ yields *†sōcan* rather than expected *sēcān*. This demonstrates that velar palatalization preceded coalescence. Nothing in the present lexicon supplies a terminus ante quem.

54 Back mutation

54.1 Historical discussion

West Saxon *giefan* ‘give’ and *wefan* ‘weave’ stand against non-West-Saxon *geofad* ‘gave’ and *weofan* ‘weave’. Ringe and Taylor use this contrast to define the dialectal profile of back mutation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 319, §6.9.4). Campbell’s treatment of diphthongization before following back vowels includes *heofon* ‘heaven’ (Campbell 1959, 86, §207), while Hogg draws the instructive comparison with breaking (Hogg 1992, 112). Fulk accordingly separates back mutation from the earlier umlautal changes (Fulk 2018, 69, §4.8).

54.2 SC059. Back mutation before labials and liquids (OEBackMutation)

```
define OEBackMutation [  
  {*e} -> {*eo} || _ [EnglishStarLabial | EnglishStarLiquid] {*u},  
  {*æ} -> {*ea} || _ [EnglishStarLabial | EnglishStarLiquid]  
    ⇨ EnglishBackMutationTrigger,  
  {*é} -> {*éo} || _ [EnglishStarLabial | EnglishStarLiquid] {*u}  
];
```

Three witness forms bracket the chronology. If back mutation precedes SC048 OESecondaryNasalization, forms such as **gébanq* ‘give’ produce *geofan* ‘give’; the expected form is *giefan* ‘give’. **stélanq* ‘steal’ likewise produces *steolan* ‘steal’; the expected form is *stelan* ‘steal’. At the other edge, delaying back mutation until after SC078 OEWeakTailReduction makes **wébanq* ‘weave’ yield *weofan* ‘weave’; the expected form is *wefan* ‘weave’. Thus back mutation follows secondary nasalization but precedes the weak-tail reductions.

55 West Saxon palatal umlaut

55.1 Historical discussion

The reflexes *miht* ‘might’ and *niht* ‘night’ place West Saxon palatal umlaut after the principal umlautal developments. Campbell and Ringe and Taylor describe the forms themselves; Fulk supplies the broader chronology of palatal-vowel change (Campbell 1959, 107–8, §§248–251; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–51, §§6.5.1, 6.6.1–6.6.4; Fulk 2018, 65, 75, §§4.7, 4.13).

55.2 SC060. West Saxon palatal umlaut before **h*-clusters (OEWSPalatalUmlaut)

```
define OEWSPalatalUmlaut [  
  {*eo} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,  
  {*io} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,  
  {*ie} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,  
  {*eo} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel,  
  {*io} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel,  
  {*ie} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel,  
  {*éo} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,  
  {*ío} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,  
  {*íe} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster .#.,  
  {*éo} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel,  
  {*ío} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel,  
  {*íe} -> {*i} || _ OEHCluster EnglishStarFrontVowel  
];
```

The change to **i* before **h*-clusters can be ordered only on its earlier side. If palatal umlaut precedes SC055 OEIUmlaut, the forms behind *miht* ‘might’ and *niht* ‘night’ remain at the overdeveloped stage [†]*mieht* and [†]*nieht* rather than expected OE *miht* and *niht*. Consequently, i-umlaut precedes palatal umlaut. Reordering the latter against any tested later change leaves both witness forms unchanged.

56 Weak-tail nasal loss

56.1 Historical discussion

The pathway from **dōnq* ‘do’ to *dōn* ‘do’ supplies the sole lexical thread through this reduction. Campbell, Hogg, and Fulk place such weak-tail losses among apocope and related late reductions (Campbell 1959, 144–45, §§345–349; Hogg 1992, 120–21; Fulk 2018, 91, §5.6). The witness, however, ties the change to a much older development. Its immediate neighbors remain untested.

56.2 SC061. Reduction of final nasal weak-tail endings (OEWeakTailNasalLoss)

```
define OEWeakTailNasalLoss [  
  {*n} {*q} -> {*n} || _ .#.,  
  {*m} {*q} -> {*m} || _ .#.  
];
```

Final weak-tail **-nq* and **-mq* accordingly yield plain **-n* and **-m*.

Only *dōn* ‘do’ constrains the relative order. Placing this loss before the older n-stem loss makes the derivation record no output instead of expected OE *dōn* ‘do’. The older loss must therefore precede weak-tail nasal loss. Nothing in the current lexicon distinguishes among its possible later positions, and one witness cannot establish a wider historical development.

57 High-vowel apocope

57.1 Historical discussion

Final high vowels must survive long enough to condition umlaut before apocope removes them after heavy syllables and in the relevant trisyllabic patterns. Campbell, Hogg, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk agree on this Old English development, though they differ over the extent of the surrounding syncope (Campbell 1959, 144–45, §§345–349; Hogg 1992, 120; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 284–303, §§6.8.1, 6.8.4; Fulk 2018, 91, §5.6).

57.2 SC063. High-vowel apocope after heavy syllables and in trisyllables (OEHighVowelApocope)

```
define OEHighVowelApocope [  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*u} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*y} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongDiphthong OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*u} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongDiphthong OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*y} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongDiphthong OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortDiphthong OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*u} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortDiphthong OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*y} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortDiphthong OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*u} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*y} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongVowel OEAnyConsonant+ EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*u} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongVowel OEAnyConsonant+ EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*y} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongVowel OEAnyConsonant+ EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongDiphthong OEAnyConsonant+ EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*u} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongDiphthong OEAnyConsonant+ EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*y} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongDiphthong OEAnyConsonant+ EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortDiphthong OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+  
    ↳ EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*u} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortDiphthong OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+  
    ↳ EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*y} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortDiphthong OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+  
    ↳ EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortDiphthong OEAnyConsonant EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*u} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortDiphthong OEAnyConsonant EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*y} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortDiphthong OEAnyConsonant EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*u} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*y} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant EnglishStarShortVowel  
    ↳ OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+  
    ↳ EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*u} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+  
    ↳ EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,  
  {*y} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+  
    ↳ EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ .#.,
```

```

    {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongVowel _ .#.,
    {*u} -> 0 || {*x} _ .#.,
    {*y} -> 0 || {*x} _ .#.,
    {*i} -> 0 || {*x} _ .#.
];

```

Final **i*, **u*, and **y* cannot disappear before completing their umlautal work. Applied before SC055 OEIUmlaut, PGmc **kūi* ‘cow’ yields [†]*cū* rather than expected OE *cȳ* ‘cow’, and PGmc **brūdiz* ‘bride’ yields [†]*brūd* rather than expected OE *brȳd* ‘bride’. Conversely, if apocope waits until after SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, PGmc **fūrxtīnaz* ‘fright’ yields [†]*fyrht* rather than expected OE *fyrhte* ‘fright’. The three witnesses establish the sequence i-umlaut, high-vowel apocope, unstressed long-vowel shortening.

58 Post-apocope **n*-loss and medial syncope

58.1 Historical discussion

Evidence for post-apocope reduction is strikingly uneven. The inherited feminine *in*-stem represented by Gothic *faurhitei*, OE *fyrhtu*, and oblique OE *fyrhte* supplies the relevant evidence (Orel 2003, 120; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 380–81; Campbell 1959, 236, §589.7). No comparable witness orders the medial syncope that follows. Hogg, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk describe both processes within the late history of weak syllables (Hogg 1992, 120–21; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 264–303, §§6.7.3–6.8.4; Fulk 2018, 91, §5.6).

58.2 SC064. Loss of stem-final **n* after long **ī* (NWGmcInStemNLoss)

```
define NWGmcInStemNLoss [{*n} -> 0 || {*ī} _ .#.];
```

Only final **n* after long **ī* is at issue, as in the inherited *in*-stem behind OE *fyrhte* ‘fright’.

CAPR models the oblique OE form through the Proto-Germanic genitive singular **fūrxtīnaz* ‘fright’, following the project convention of using an appropriate non-nominative paradigm cell when the nominative does not supply the required derivation. Within this selected genitive derivation, the same input fixes both ordering boundaries. Before SC041 PWGmcFinalBareALoss, PGmc **fūrxtīnaz* ‘fright’ yields *†fyrhten* rather than expected OE *fyrhte* ‘fright’. After SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, PGmc **fūrxtīnaz* again yields *†fyrhten* rather than expected *fyrhte* ‘fright’. I therefore order final bare-a loss, stem-final *n*-loss, and unstressed long-vowel shortening in that sequence. Both boundaries are firm within the selected genitive derivation and depend on one inherited lexeme/paradigm.

58.3 SC065. Medial syncope before dentals after heavy syllables (OEMedialSyncope)

Loss of medial **i* before dentals belongs to the late weak-tail history described by Hogg, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk (Hogg 1992, 120–21; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 264–303, §§6.7.3–6.8.4; Fulk 2018, 91, §5.6).

```
define OEMedialSyncope [  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ [{*θ}|{*ð}|{*d}|{*t}],  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongDiphthong OEAnyConsonant+ _ [{*θ}|{*ð}|{*d}|{*t}],  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant OEAnyConsonant+ _  
    ↳ [{*θ}|{*ð}|{*d}|{*t}]  
];
```

No diagnostic word establishes a local chronology. Moving medial syncope to either end of the tested range leaves every output unchanged. Its handbook placement after apocope and before later cluster simplification therefore remains preferable, but the present lexicon cannot demonstrate it.

59 Late syncope and degemination

59.1 Historical discussion

Vowel loss creates the clusters upon which later assimilation and degemination operate. Hogg and Ringe and Taylor describe this dependence, while Brunner’s *netle* ‘nettle’ beside later *nete* ‘nettle’ supplies a concrete lexical type (Hogg 1992, 120–21; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 264–96, §§6.7.3–6.8.2; Brunner 1965, 144–45, §§158–159). Fulk places this syncope after i-umlaut (Fulk 2018, 91, §5.6).

The three relations are not equally secure. Lexical evidence orders syncope and degemination; the intervening dental assimilation has no independent ordering witness.

59.2 SC066. L-adjacent syncope in medial syllables (OELAdjacentSyncope)

```
define OELAdjacentSyncope [  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ {*l},  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarLongVowel OEAnyConsonant+ _ {*l},  
  {*i} -> 0 || EnglishStarDiphthong OEAnyConsonant+ _ {*l}  
];
```

The loss of medial **i* before **l* is late enough to preserve earlier umlaut, as *netle* ‘nettle’ and *spinl* ‘spindle’ demonstrate.

Placed before i-umlaut, PGmc **nátílōn* ‘nettle’ yields [†]*nætle* rather than expected OE *netle* ‘nettle’, and PGmc **spénnilō* ‘spindle’ yields [†]*spenl* rather than expected *spinl* ‘spindle’. Placed after preconsonantal degemination, PGmc **spénnilō* yields [†]*spinnl* rather than expected *spinl*. The witnesses therefore establish the sequence i-umlaut, l-adjacent syncope, preconsonantal degemination. The first relation separates two historical phases; the second is a direct feeding relation, since syncope creates the cluster that degemination simplifies.

59.3 SC067. Dental assimilation in newly formed clusters (OEDentalAssimilation)

```
define OEDentalAssimilation [  
  {*θ} -> 0 || {*t} _  
];
```

Loss of **θ* after **t* resolves a dental cluster produced by syncope (Hogg 1992, 120–21; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 279–96, §§6.7.5, 6.8.2). No witness distinguishes its position: moving dental assimilation across every tested neighbor leaves the outputs unchanged. I nevertheless place it after syncope, which supplies its input, and before the more general cluster simplification described in the handbooks. This order is phonologically motivated, not established by a lexical contrast.

59.4 SC068. Preconsonantal degemination before sonorants (OEPreconsonantalDegemination)

```
define OEPreconsonantalDegemination OEPreconsonantalDegemTT .o.  
  ⇨ OEPreconsonantalDegemNN;
```

Preconsonantal **tt* and **nn* simplify only after syncope has created a following sonorant cluster, as in *spinl* ‘spindle’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 279–96, §§6.7.5, 6.8.2).

Placed before l-adjacent syncope, PGmc **spénnilō* ‘spindle’ yields [†]*spinnl* rather than expected OE *spinl* ‘spindle’. Syncope must therefore create the cluster before degemination simplifies it.

Reordering degemination against any tested later change leaves the witness unchanged, so no terminus ante quem is known.

60 Early o-shortening

60.1 Historical discussion

After the principal palatal andumlaut changes, unstressed vowels undergo shortening, fronting, merger, and sometimes complete loss. Campbell describes the early shortening of unaccented long vowels, while Hogg, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk relate it to apocope, syncope, and the later reductions (Campbell 1959, 148, §355; Hogg 1992, 120–21; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 298–314, §§6.8.3–6.9.3; Fulk 2018, 90–96, §§5.6–5.7).

Early o-shortening has only a distant earlier boundary. The rules that follow, especially SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly and SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, have more closely defined relations.

60.2 SC069. Early shortening of unstressed *ō before nasals (OEEarlyOShortening)

```
define OEEarlyOShortening [  
  { *ō } -> { *a } || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |  
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ EnglishStarNasal  
];
```

The rule shortens unstressed long *ō before a following nasal. Because this shortening happens early, the resulting *a can still participate in the later fronting and merger that shape many weak final syllables.

Moving the rule before SC023 PNWGmcNStemNLoss, PGmc **nēdrōn* ‘adder’ yields †*nædran* rather than expected OE *nædre* ‘adder’, PGmc **érθōn* ‘earth’ yields †*eorþan* rather than expected *eorþe* ‘earth’, and PGmc **fláskōn* ‘flask’ yields †*flascan* rather than expected *flasce* ‘flask’. The same earlier shift also disrupts forms such as *heorte* ‘heart’ and *līne* ‘line’. This broad set of failures requires SC069 OEEarlyOShortening to follow SC023 PNWGmcNStemNLoss.

If the rule is moved later within the tested sequence, no output differs from the expected one. The lexical evidence therefore does not identify a corresponding later constraint. The sources place early *ō-shortening before the later weak-tail changes without fixing a closer local order.

61 Early unstressed fronting and later o-shortening

61.1 Historical discussion

Campbell distinguishes the shortening of unaccented long vowels, while Hogg, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk place fronting and shortening within a later history of syncope and final-vowel adjustment (Campbell 1959, 148, §355; Hogg 1992, 120–21; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 298–314, §§6.8.3–6.9.3; Fulk 2018, 90–96, §§5.6–5.7). Earlier unstressed fronting precedes later o-shortening.

SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly has both an earlier and a later lexical breakpoint. SC071 OELateOShortening confirms their reciprocal order, but no lexical evidence fixes its later boundary.

61.2 SC070. Early fronting of unstressed **a* (OEUnstressedFrontingEarly)

```
define OEUnstressedFrontingEarly OEUnstressedAFronting;
```

The rule fronts unstressed **a* to **æ* after the earlier shortening has created a frontable vowel but before the later shortening of unstressed **ō*. It produces endings such as OE *-en* in *lungen* ‘lungs’.

If the rule is moved before SC052 OEVelarPalatalization, PGmc **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’ yields *†lungen* rather than expected OE *lungen* ‘lungs’. If the rule is delayed until after SC071 OELateOShortening, PGmc **búrōθi* ‘bears’ yields *†boreþ* rather than expected OE *boraþ* ‘bears’, and PGmc **ménōθz* ‘month’ yields *†mōneþ* rather than expected *mōnaþ* ‘month’. The witness forms require SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly to follow SC052 OEVelarPalatalization and precede SC071 OELateOShortening.

The relation to SC071 OELateOShortening is local. The earlier boundary at SC052 OEVelarPalatalization places fronting after the older palatal developments.

61.3 SC071. Later shortening of unstressed **ō* (OELateOShortening)

The following rule handles the later shortening stage.

```
define OELateOShortening [  
  {*ō} -> {*o} || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |  
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ [EnglishStarConsonant |  
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant]*  
];
```

The rule shortens the remaining unstressed long **ō* after fronting. The shortened vowel is then resolved by the following medial/final distribution, not directly as *a* (Stausland Johnsen 2015, 28–31).

Moving the rule before SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly makes PGmc **búrōθi* ‘bears’ yield *†boreþ* rather than expected OE *boraþ* ‘bears’, and PGmc **líznoθi* ‘learns’ yield *†liorneþ* rather than expected *liornaþ* ‘learns’. The contrast requires SC071 OELateOShortening to follow SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly.

61.4 SC099. Medial raising of shortened unstressed **o* (OEMedUnstressedORaising)

```
define OEMedUnstressedORaising [  
  {*o} -> {*u} || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |  
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ [EnglishStarConsonant |  
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant]* EnglishStarVocalic  
];
```

After SC071 OELateOShortening, the shortened vowel gives *u* in an unstressed medial syllable. The rule encodes Stausland Johnsen’s statistically supported account of West Saxon *ō*-verb pasts, not a general rule for inherited short **o* or for nominal morphology (Stausland Johnsen 2015, 28–31, 36). His diagnostic derivation is PGmc **wúndōdē* ‘wounded’ > *†wundode* > OE *wundude* ‘wounded’ (Stausland Johnsen 2015, 28–29).

61.5 SC100. Final lowering of shortened unstressed **o* (OEFinalUnstressedOLowering)

```
define OEFinalUnstressedOLowering [
  {*o} -> {*a} || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ [EnglishStarConsonant |
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant]* .#.
];
```

In a final syllable the same shortened vowel gives *a*. Thus the existing month control continues PGmc **mēnōθz* ‘month’ through shortened **o* to OE *mōnaþ* ‘month’, while **wúndōdē* ‘wounded’ takes SC099 OEMedUnstressedORaising instead. The medial/final contrast and its chronology after long-vowel shortening are Stausland Johnsen’s analysis (Stausland Johnsen 2015, 28–31).

62 Unstressed long-vowel shortening and ae-merger

62.1 Historical discussion

Campbell describes the shortening of unaccented long vowels, and Ringe and Taylor place it among the last prehistoric Old English changes before the merger of unstressed *æ with *e (Campbell 1959, 148, §355; Hogg 1992, 120–21; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 298–314, §§6.8.3–6.9.3; Fulk 2018, 90–96, §§5.6–5.7).

SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening and SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger have a reciprocal ordering relation. SC064 NWGmcInStemNLoss supplies the earlier boundary of shortening, and SC085 OEHLoss the later boundary of the merger.

62.2 SC072. Shortening of unstressed long vowels (OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening)

```
define OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening1
  .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening2
  .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening3
  .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening5
  .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening6
  .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening7
  .o. OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening8;
```

The rule shortens the remaining unstressed long vowels before weak final syllables reach their later forms. A small group of lexical witnesses fixes its chronology.

If the rule is moved before SC064 NWGmcInStemNLoss, PGmc **fúrxtīnaz* ‘fright’ yields †*fyrhten* rather than expected OE *fyrhte* ‘fright’. If the rule is delayed until after SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger, PGmc **nēdrōn* ‘adder’ yields †*nædræ* rather than expected OE *nædre* ‘adder’, and PGmc **fādēr* ‘father’ yields †*fædær* rather than expected *fæder* ‘father’. These outputs require SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening to follow SC064 NWGmcInStemNLoss and precede SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger.

Shortening therefore follows the earlier weak-tail preparation and immediately precedes the merger.

62.3 SC073. Merger of unstressed *æ with *e (OEUnstressedAEMerger)

The following rule handles the merger stage.

```
define OEUnstressedAEMerger OEWeakTailReduction3;
```

The rule merges unstressed *æ with *e after shortening has produced the weak final vowels, yielding the ordinary OE -e spellings.

Its earlier and later relations are both concrete. If the rule is moved before SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, PGmc **nēdrōn* ‘adder’ yields †*nædræ* rather than expected OE *nædre* ‘adder’, and PGmc **fādēr* ‘father’ yields †*fædær* rather than expected *fæder* ‘father’. If the rule is delayed until after SC085 OEHLoss, PGmc **táixōn* ‘toe’ yields †*tāæ* rather than expected OE *tā* ‘toe’. These failures show that SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening must come before SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger, and that SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger must come before SC085 OEHLoss.

The lexical evidence fixes the local order after SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening and places the merger before the later h-loss and contraction.

63 Medial unstressed-i lowering

63.1 Historical discussion

Hogg and Ringe and Taylor treat the late weakening and merger of unstressed vowels as a continuing history (Hogg 1992, 120–21; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 327–32, §§6.9.5–6.9.6). SC074 OMedUnstressedILowering1 lowers medial unstressed *i*; SC075 OMedUnstressedILowering preserves *i* before **ng* in words of the *scilling* ‘shilling’ type.

General lowering precedes the restricted restoration before **ng*. The evidence is narrower than that for SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening and SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger.

63.2 SC074. First medial unstressed-i lowering (OMedUnstressedILowering1)

```
define OMedUnstressedILowering1 [  
  {*i} -> {*e} || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |  
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _  
];
```

The rule lowers medial unstressed **i* to **e* after a preceding vocalic syllable. The resulting *e*-outcome is reversed before **ng*.

If the rule is moved before SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening, PGmc **fúrxtīnaz* ‘fright’ yields *†fyrhti* rather than expected OE *fyrhte* ‘fright’. If it is delayed until after SC075 OMedUnstressedILowering, PGmc **skillingaz* ‘shilling’ yields *†scilleng* rather than expected *scilling* ‘shilling’. The derivations require SC074 OMedUnstressedILowering1 to follow SC072 OEUnstressedLongVowelShortening and precede SC075 OMedUnstressedILowering.

The evidence is narrow on each side. The rule follows unstressed long-vowel shortening and precedes the more specific **ng* preservation.

63.3 SC075. Preservation of medial unstressed **i* before **ng* (OMedUnstressedILowering)

The following rule reverses the lowering before **ng*.

```
define OMedUnstressedILowering [  
  {*e} -> {*i} || _ {*n} {*g}  
];
```

The rule restores **i* before **ng*, preventing the broader lowering from producing the wrong medial vowel in forms such as *scilling* ‘shilling’.

Moving the rule before SC074 OMedUnstressedILowering1 makes PGmc **skillingaz* ‘shilling’ yield *†scilleng* rather than expected OE *scilling* ‘shilling’. On this evidence, I take SC075 OMedUnstressedILowering to follow SC074 OMedUnstressedILowering1. Moving it later within the tested range creates no equally sharp failure.

64 Prefix i-reduction

64.1 Historical discussion

Late weak-tail reduction affects unstressed prefixes as well as inflectional endings and medial vowels. Fulk’s discussion of prefix vowels accounts for OE **be-* and **ne-* (Fulk 2018, 97, §5.7). Hogg and Ringe and Taylor place such weakening within the broader late history of unstressed vowels (Hogg 1992, 120–21; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 298–332, §§6.8.3–6.9.6).

The tested forms do not determine the rule’s position relative to a neighboring change.

64.2 SC076. Reduction of prefixal **i* in unstressed position (OEPrefixIReduction)

```
define OEPrefixIReduction [  
  {*i} -> {*ë} || .#. [{*b} | {*n}] _ [EnglishStarConsonant |  
    ↳ EnglishPalatalConsonant] EnglishStarVocalic  
];
```

The rule reduces unstressed prefixal **i* to a weaker vowel in the *bi-* and *ni-* type prefixes before a consonant plus a following vowel. The development accounts for later prefix spellings such as OE **be-* and **ne-*.

If the rule is moved earlier or later within the tested sequence, no output differs from the expected one. The lexical evidence therefore does not place SC076 OEPrefixIReduction before or after any specific neighboring change.

The handbooks attest late prefix-vowel weakening, but the precise placement remains approximate. No lexical failure fixes it.

65 Weak-tail reduction

65.1 Historical discussion

Campbell, Hogg, Ringe and Taylor, and Fulk describe a late history in which apocope, shortening, contraction, and further weak-tail reductions reshape final syllables (Campbell 1959, 148, §355; Hogg 1992, 120–21; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 298–314, §§6.8.3–6.9.3; Fulk 2018, 90–91, §5.6). Lexical failures place the remaining weak-tail reduction after unstressed fronting and before contraction.

65.2 SC078. Reduction of remaining weak-tail vowels (OEWeakTailReduction)

```
define OEWeakTailReduction OEWeakTailReduction1;
```

The rule reduces the remaining weak-tail vowels, preventing a broad class of *-en* and extra-vowel outcomes.

I place the change after SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly and before SC086 OEContraction. Moving it before SC070 OEUnstressedFrontingEarly, PGmc **bákanq* ‘bake’ yields [†]*bacen* rather than expected OE *bacan* ‘bake’, and PGmc **bíndanq* ‘bind’ yields [†]*binden* rather than expected *bindan* ‘bind’, alongside a much wider set of comparable *-en* failures. If the rule is delayed until after SC086 OEContraction, PGmc **fléuxanq* ‘flee’ yields [†]*flēoan* rather than expected OE *flēon* ‘flee’, and PGmc **sláxanq* ‘slay’ yields [†]*sleaan* rather than expected *slēan* ‘slay’.

The earlier boundary spans a wide interval and does not establish a close neighboring relation. The later boundary is narrower: SC078 OEWeakTailReduction precedes SC086 OEContraction.

66 Final-j loss and final geminate simplification

66.1 Historical discussion

After SC079 OEJLossAfterHeavy removes **j* in heavy environments, forms such as *lungen* ‘lungs’ acquire a final geminate. SC080 OEFinalGeminateSimplification then removes the second nasal.

SC079 OEJLossAfterHeavy has a broad earlier boundary at SC055 OEIUmlaut. SC080 OEFinalGeminateSimplification is fixed only by the final *nn* outcome in the following derivation.

66.2 SC079. Loss of **j* after heavy syllables (OEJLossAfterHeavy)

```
define OEJLossAfterHeavy [  
  {*j} -> 0 || (EnglishStarLongVowel | EnglishStarDiphthong)  
  ↳ [EnglishStarConsonantNoR | EnglishPalatalConsonant] _ ,  
  {*j} -> 0 || EnglishStarShortVowel [EnglishStarConsonant |  
  ↳ EnglishPalatalConsonant] [EnglishStarConsonantNoR |  
  ↳ EnglishPalatalConsonant] _  
];
```

The rule removes **j* after the relevant heavy-syllable configurations, after the earlier umlaut-sensitive vocalism has developed. The affected glide is **j*.

If the rule is moved before SC055 OEIUmlaut, PGmc **galáubijanq* ‘believe’ yields *†gelēafan* rather than expected OE *geliefan* ‘believe’, PGmc **báugijanq* ‘bow’ yields *†bēagan* rather than expected *bīegan* ‘bow’, and PGmc **fúlгийнq* ‘follow’ yields *†fulgan* rather than expected *fylgan* ‘follow’. If it is delayed until after SC080 OEFinalGeminateSimplification, PGmc **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’ yields *†lungenn* rather than expected OE *lungen* ‘lungs’. I accordingly take SC079 OEJLossAfterHeavy to follow SC055 OEIUmlaut and precede SC080 OEFinalGeminateSimplification.

The earlier boundary is broad, but the relation to final geminate simplification is local.

66.3 SC080. Simplification of final geminates (OEFinalGeminateSimplification)

The following rule handles the final simplification directly.

```
define OEFinalGeminateSimplification [  
  {*n} -> 0 || {*n} _ .#.  
];
```

The rule removes the extra final nasal in forms where the preceding derivation has already created a final geminate.

Moving the rule before SC079 OEJLossAfterHeavy makes PGmc **lúnganjō* ‘lungs’ yield *†lungenn* rather than expected OE *lungen* ‘lungs’. These failures require SC080 OEFinalGeminateSimplification to follow SC079 OEJLossAfterHeavy. Moving it later within the tested range before SC087 OERMetathesis creates no new failure.

67 J-strengthening, vocalization, and ei-contraction

67.1 Historical discussion

SC081 OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong preserves a consonantal outcome after front diphthongs. SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization then vocalizes the remaining intervocalic **j*, and SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction removes the resulting *ei*-like sequence in weak verbal endings.

The output of each rule conditions the next. SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization has local lexical evidence on both sides; SC081 OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong has a distant earlier boundary, and SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction has no tested later boundary.

67.2 SC081. Strengthening of **j* after front diphthongs (OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong)

```
define OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong [  
  {*j} -> {*ʒ} || [{*ēa}|{*éa}|{*īe}|{*īe}|{*éa}] _ EnglishStarVocalic  
];
```

After the relevant front diphthongs, **j* first strengthened to a consonantal outcome; otherwise it would have vocalized too early.

If the rule is moved before SC055 OEIUmlaut, PGmc **stráwjanq* ‘strew’ yields [†]*strēagan* rather than expected OE *strīegan* ‘strew’. If it is delayed until after SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization, the same PGmc form yields [†]*strīeian* rather than *strīegan*. The order test requires SC081 OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong to follow SC055 OEIUmlaut and precede SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization.

The earlier constraint reaches back to SC055 OEIUmlaut and therefore defines a wide interval. The *strīegan* ‘strew’ derivation fixes the local relation to SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization.

67.3 SC082. Intervocalic vocalization of **j* (OEIntervocalicJVocalization)

```
define OEIntervocalicJVocalization [  
  {*j} -> {*i} || EnglishStarVocalic _ EnglishStarVocalic  
];
```

The rule vocalizes intervocalic **j* to **i*, creating the *ei*-like sequence later removed by SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction in many weak verb forms.

Moving the rule before SC081 OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong makes PGmc **stráwjanq* ‘strew’ yield [†]*strīeian* rather than expected OE *strīegan* ‘strew’. Delaying it until after SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction makes PGmc **búrōjanq* ‘bore’ yield [†]*boreian* rather than expected OE *borian* ‘bore’, PGmc **xándlōjanq* ‘handle’ yield [†]*handleian* rather than expected *handlian* ‘handle’, and PGmc **mákōjanq* ‘make’ yield [†]*maceian* rather than expected *macian* ‘make’. The witness forms require SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization to follow SC081 OEJStrengtheningAfterFrontDiphthong and precede SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction.

SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization is therefore ordered between strengthening and contraction.

67.4 SC083. Contraction of unstressed *ei* (OEUnstressedEIContraction)

The final rule removes the extra unstressed *e* before *i*.

```
define OEUnstressedEIContraction [  
  {*e} -> ∅ || EnglishStarVocalic [EnglishStarConsonant |  
    ↪ EnglishPalatalConsonant]+ _ {*i}
```

The rule contracts the unstressed *ei*-like sequence that the preceding vocalization would otherwise leave behind in forms such as *borian* ‘bore’ and *liccian* ‘lick’.

Moving the rule before SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization makes PGmc **būrōjaną* ‘bore’ yield [†]*boreian* rather than expected OE *borian* ‘bore’, PGmc **līznōjaną* ‘learn’ yield [†]*liorneian* rather than expected *liornian* ‘learn’, and PGmc **līkkōjaną* ‘lick’ yield [†]*licceian* rather than expected *liccian* ‘lick’. The contrast requires SC083 OEUnstressedEIContraction to follow SC082 OEIntervocalicJVocalization. Moving it later within the tested range before SC087 OERMetathesis creates no new failure.

68 H-loss and contraction

68.1 Historical discussion

When SC085 OEHLoss removes intervocalic **h*, it creates hiatus. SC086 OEContraction immediately resolves the resulting vowel sequence.

Ringe and Taylor describe this late sequence of *h*-loss and contraction (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 305–14, §§6.9.1–6.9.3). Fulk places the contracted verbs in a broader Germanic context (Fulk 2018, 270, §12.21), and Luick describes the corresponding West Germanic contractions (Luick 1914–1940, 165).

68.2 SC085. Loss of intervocalic **h* (OEHLoss)

```
define OEHLoss [  
  {*x} -> 0 || EnglishStarVocalic _ EnglishStarVocalic  
];
```

The rule removes intervocalic **h*, creating the hiatus that later contraction must resolve.

If the rule is moved before SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger, PGmc **táixōn* ‘toe’ yields [†]*tāæ* rather than expected OE *tā* ‘toe’. If it is delayed until after SC086 OEContraction, PGmc **fléuxanq* ‘flee’ yields [†]*flēoan* rather than expected OE *flēon* ‘flee’, PGmc **sláxanq* ‘slay’ yields [†]*sleaan* rather than expected *slēan* ‘slay’, PGmc **téxun* ‘draw’ yields [†]*teoon* rather than expected *tēon* ‘draw’, and PGmc **táixōn* yields [†]*tāe* rather than expected *tā*. These outputs require SC085 OEHLoss to follow SC073 OEUnstressedAEMerger and precede SC086 OEContraction.

The earlier boundary rests on one witness; the four later witnesses establish the immediate relation to contraction.

68.3 SC086. Contraction of the resulting hiatus (OEContraction)

The following rule contracts the hiatus left by SC085 OEHLoss.

```
define OEContraction [  
  {*a} {*a} -> {*ā},  
  {*e} {*e} -> {*ē},  
  {*i} {*i} -> {*ī},  
  {*o} {*o} -> {*ō},  
  {*u} {*u} -> {*ū},  
  {*ea} {*a} -> {*ēa},  
  {*ēa} {*a} -> {*ēa},  
  {*eo} {*a} -> {*ēo},  
  {*ēo} {*a} -> {*ēo},  
  {*eo} {*o} -> {*ēo},  
  {*ēo} {*o} -> {*ēo},  
  {*éo} {*o} -> {*éó},  
  {*éó} {*o} -> {*éó},  
  {*ā} {*a} -> {*ā},  
  {*ā} {*e} -> {*ā},  
  {*ē} {*a} -> {*ē},  
  {*ē} {*e} -> {*ē},  
  {*é} {*a} -> {*é},  
  {*é} {*e} -> {*é},  
  {*ī} {*a} -> {*ī},  
  {*ī} {*e} -> {*ī},  
  {*í} {*a} -> {*í},  
  {*í} {*e} -> {*í},  
  {*ō} {*a} -> {*ō},  
  {*ō} {*e} -> {*ō},  
  {*ū} {*a} -> {*ū},
```

{ *ū } { *e } -> { *ū }];

The rule contracts the vowel sequences created after *h*-loss, producing *flēon* ‘flee’, *slēan* ‘slay’, and *tēon* ‘draw’.

Moving contraction before SC085 OEHLoss makes PGmc **fléuxanq* ‘flee’ yield *†flēoan* rather than expected OE *flēon* ‘flee’, PGmc **sláxanq* ‘slay’ yield *†sleaen* rather than expected *slēan* ‘slay’, PGmc **téxun* ‘draw’ yield *†teoon* rather than expected *tēon* ‘draw’, and PGmc **táixōn* ‘toe’ yield *†tāe* rather than expected *tā* ‘toe’. The derivations require SC086 OEContraction to follow SC085 OEHLoss. Moving it later within the tested range before SC087 OERMetathesis creates no new failure. The more distant SC078 OEWeakTailReduction relation establishes only that weak-tail reduction precedes contraction.

69 R-metathesis

69.1 Historical discussion

Sievers-Brunner describes r-metathesis in forms such as *berstan* ‘burst’, *forst* ‘frost’, and *cærse* ‘cress’ (Brunner 1965, 159, §179). Luick likewise treats it as a later rearrangement whose interaction with breaking remains variable (Luick 1914–1940, 201).

The evidence establishes that breaking precedes metathesis. It does not establish an ordering relation between SC086 OEContraction and SC087 OERMetathesis.

69.2 SC087. Metathesis of **r* with a following short vowel (OERMetathesis)

```
define OERMetathesis [  
  {*r} {*e} -> {*e} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},  
  {*r} {*u} -> {*u} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},  
  {*r} {*i} -> {*i} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},  
  {*r} {*o} -> {*o} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},  
  {*r} {*a} -> {*a} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},  
  {*r} {*é} -> {*é} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},  
  {*r} {*ó} -> {*ó} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t},  
  {*r} {*á} -> {*á} {*r} || EnglishStarConsonant _ {*s} {*t}  
];
```

The rule moves **r* across a following short vowel in the relevant late clusters, producing forms such as *berstan* ‘burst’ where an earlier order would still show a broken vowel sequence.

Moving the rule before SC044 OEBreaking makes PGmc **bréstanq* ‘burst’ yield *†beorstan* rather than expected OE *berstan* ‘burst’. On this evidence, I take SC087 OERMetathesis to follow SC044 OEBreaking. Moving it later within the tested sequence alters no output.

The lexical evidence fixes the earlier relation but does not identify a corresponding later constraint. The sources treat r-metathesis as a late rearrangement after breaking without placing it immediately beside contraction.

70 Chapter 5. Old English orthography and the written surface

70.1 Historical interval

This short chapter stands apart from the derivational chapters that precede it. The changes of Chapters 1–3 are sound changes: they altered the spoken form of the language. The material treated here belongs instead to the written surface of Old English — scribal conventions that determined how the results of the completed phonological history were committed to parchment.

In the executable model these conventions apply after every phonological rule, at the very end of the cascade, because that is where they belong historically: a spelling practice can only render forms that the spoken language had already produced.

70.2 Scope

The one rule treated here is the West Saxon palatal-glide spelling (SC016), by which back vowels following word-initial [j] — spelled *g* — came to be written with a preceding front glide letter, as in *geoc* ‘yoke’ for spoken [jok] and *geogub* ‘youth’ for a form whose root vowel remained [u]. Ringe and Taylor state the modern assessment directly: the *eo* of *geoc* is a spelling convention, and the word was pronounced [jok] (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 5). Hogg reaches the same verdict for the back-vowel cases generally (Hogg 1992, 112). The older handbooks — Campbell, Brunner, Bülbring, Luick — analysed the same spellings as rising diphthongs; the section below presents both views (Campbell 1959, 17, § 44; Brunner 1965, 64–65, § 92).

70.3 Sources

Ringe and Taylor provide the modern phonological interpretation (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 5). Campbell (Campbell 1959, 17, 64–67, §§ 44, 170–176), Brunner (Brunner 1965, 64–65, § 92), and Bülbring (Bülbring 1902, 120, §§ 298–299) document the distribution of the spellings; Hogg supplies the critical reassessment (Hogg 1992, 112).

71 West Saxon palatal-glide spelling before back vowels

71.1 Historical discussion

West Saxon spellings such as *geoc* ‘yoke’, *geong* ‘young’, and *geogub* ‘youth’ write a front glide letter between a word-initial palatal and a following back vowel. Campbell describes the phenomenon as the development of rising diphthongs when “palatal glides developed before back vowels” and cites *geoc* directly (Campbell 1959, 17, §44); Brunner separates the *u*-cases (*geong*, *geogub*) from the *o*-cases (*gioc* ‘yoke’, *geoc*) (Brunner 1965, 64–65, §92.1); Bülbring likewise treats *iuguð* ‘youth’ and *iuc* under *ju* but derives *gioc*, *geoc* from West Germanic **jok* (Bülbring 1902, 120, §§298–299); and Luick groups all of these under his “schwebende Diphthonge” after palatal onsets (Luick 1914–1940, 158–59, §169).

The phonological interpretation of these spellings is disputed. The older handbook tradition — Campbell, Brunner, Bülbring, Luick — reads them as genuine rising diphthongs. The modern assessment is orthographic: Ringe and Taylor state flatly that *geoc* “is /jok/”, the digraph being a spelling convention that became universal after word-initial /j/ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 5), and Hogg concludes that the back-vowel cases were “never anything more than an orthographic variation”, judging Campbell’s arguments to the contrary “insubstantial” (Hogg 1992, 112; Campbell 1959, 66–67, §176). This model follows Ringe and Taylor and Hogg: the rule is a spelling convention applied to the finished phonology, and it therefore stands at the end of the derivation, in the written-surface stage of the cascade.

Its position also settles a relative chronology. The *o* of *geoc* ‘yoke’ is itself the product of Northwest Germanic u-lowering (SC017 PNWGMcULowering): Fulk lists *geoc* as a regular lowering example beside OIcel *ok* and OHG *joh* (Fulk 2018, 56, §4.3), and Campbell gives *geoc* among the regular *u* >

o words (Campbell 1959, 43, §115). The lowering therefore feeds the spelling: first **juk-* became **jok-* in Northwest Germanic, and only much later did West Saxon scribes write the result as *ġeoc*. Where lowering did not apply, as in *ġeogub* ‘youth’, whose root *u* was protected by the high vowel of the following syllable, the same convention wrote the retained *u* with the same digraph (Brunner 1965, 64–65, §92.1).

71.2 SC016. West Saxon palatal-glide spelling before back vowels (OEwsPalatalGlide)

```
define OEwsPalatalGlide [
  { *ó } -> { *éo } || .#. ġ _ ,
  { *ú } -> { *éo } || .#. ġ _ ,
  { *o } -> { *eo } || .#. ġ _ ,
  { *u } -> { *eo } || .#. ġ _
];
```

The rule rewrites a back vowel after word-initial *ġ* as the digraph spelling, covering both the lowered *o*-cases (*ġeoc* ‘yoke’) and the retained *u*-cases (*ġeogub* ‘youth’). Because it is a convention of the written language, it applies after every phonological change; in particular it follows SC017 PNWGmcULowering, which supplies the *o* of *ġeoc*. If the spelling rule were placed before *u*-lowering, the derivation would have to treat an Old English scribal practice as a Northwest Germanic sound change, an ordering that no source supports. The witnesses *ġeoc* and *ġeogub* between them fix both faces of the rule: one shows the convention applied to lowered *o*, the other to unlowered *u*. The handbook domain is broader (it also includes *a/ā/ō* contexts after word-initial palatals), but this executable rule is intentionally complete for the currently selected corpus witnesses rather than a maximal dialectal enumeration.

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